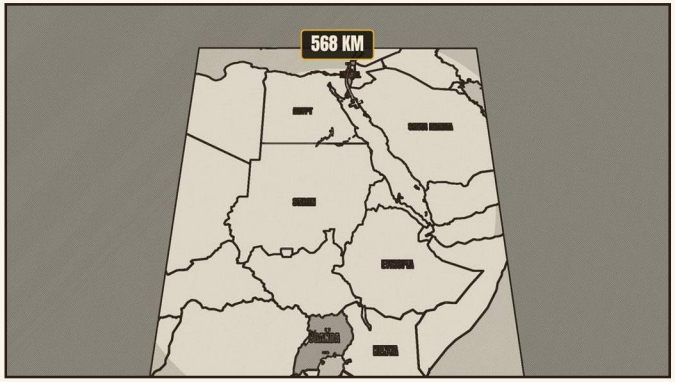
OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 0 COLD OPEN

0.1 · 7.8s

VO Eleven at night, 3 July 1976. Four huge military planes fly over Africa with every light switched off.
FRAME Four C-130 Hercules in a row, black against a starfield, cloud tops lit by the moon
MOTION slow lateral dolly along the formation, camera 30 m below the lead wing



0.2 · 7.0s

VO They have come four thousand kilometres from Israel, flying so low that no radar sees them.
FRAME Parchment map, Israel to Uganda; gold route ribbon grows down the Red Sea; "4,000 KM" counter ticks up
MOTION crane down from above Sinai, follow the ribbon south

0.3 · 8.2s

VO Near the target, the lead plane shuts down two of its four engines so it lands almost in silence.
FRAME Close on the wing: two propellers slow and stop, the other two keep turning
MOTION push in on the stopping propellers

0.4 · 9.8s

VO Its ramp opens while it is still rolling. Out comes a black Mercedes, built to look exactly like the car of Uganda's president.
FRAME Ramp lowers on a dark runway; a black Mercedes and two Land Rovers roll out with flags on the bonnet
MOTION low angle from the runway, ramp opens toward camera

0.5 · 7.4s

VO Inside an old airport terminal, a hundred and six hostages are waiting. Their deadline is tomorrow afternoon.
FRAME Old terminal at night, one window lit, silhouettes of people lying on the floor inside
MOTION slow push toward the lit window

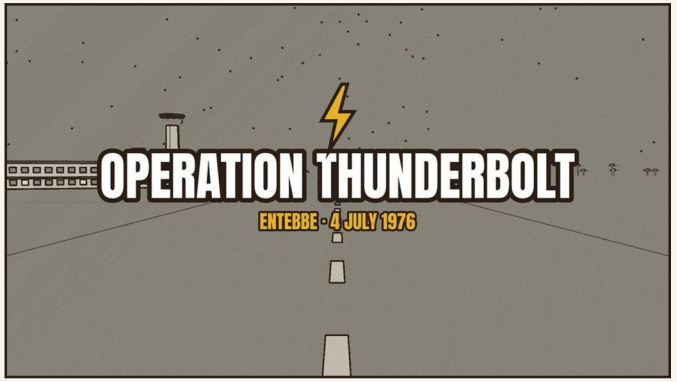
0.6 · 6.6s

VO The man leading the first team is thirty years old. His name is Yonatan Netanyahu.
FRAME Yoni in olive uniform and cap, sitting in the Mercedes, eyes calm; name callout
MOTION over-the-shoulder close, slight handheld drift

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 0 COLD OPEN

0.7 · 10.6s

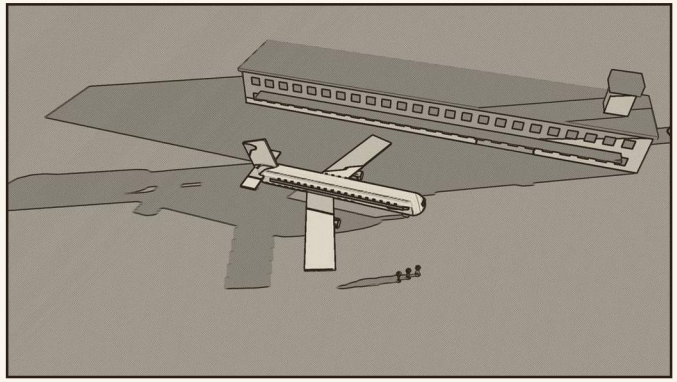
VO In the next ninety minutes, Israel will try something no army had done before. A rescue in an enemy country, four thousand kilometres from home.
FRAME The convoy moves toward the terminal, headlights off, the airport tower ahead
MOTION camera rises and pulls back to reveal the whole airport



0.8 · 3.0s

VO This is Operation Thunderbolt.
FRAME "OPERATION THUNDERBOLT" slams in over the dark runway, lightning bolt emblem
MOTION title slam 1.9x to 1x, then slow push

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 1 FLIGHT 139

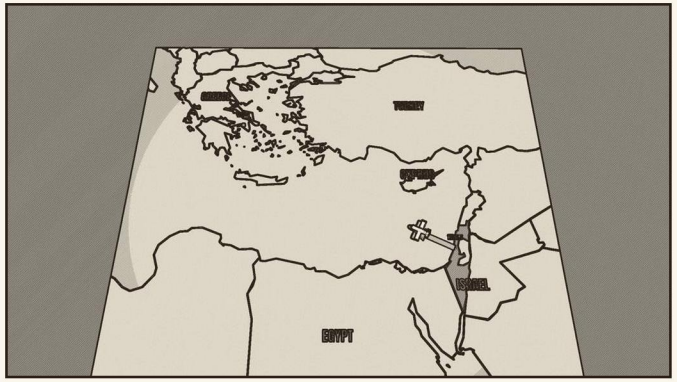


1.1 · 5.0s

VO Let's go back one week. Tel Aviv, Sunday 27 June 1976.
FRAME Ben Gurion airport, morning sun, an Air France Airbus A300 at the gate
MOTION crane down from sky to the jet

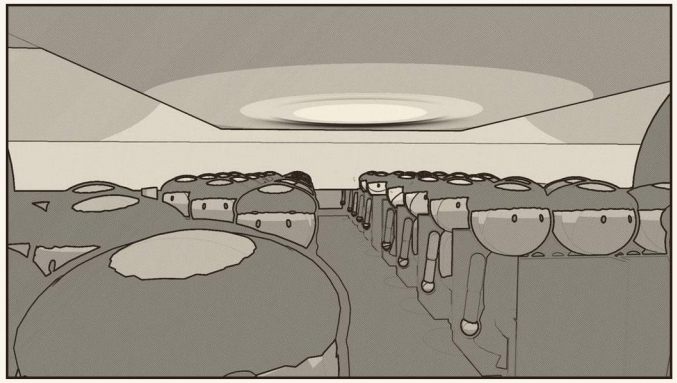
1.2 · 7.0s

VO Air France Flight 139 is going to Paris, with one stop on the way in Athens.
FRAME Departure board flips to "AF 139 PARIS VIA ATHENS"
MOTION push in on the board



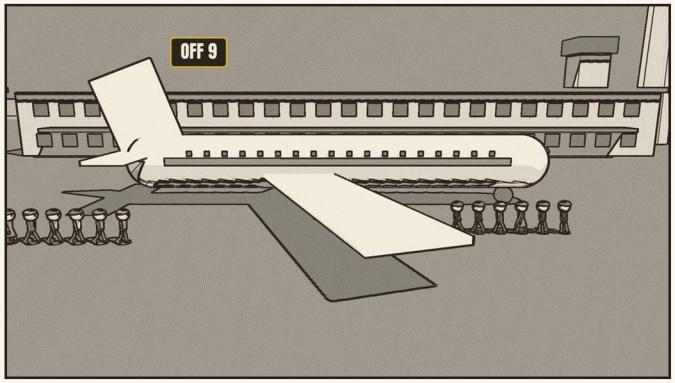
1.3 · 7.0s

VO It leaves on time, just before nine in the morning, and turns west over the Mediterranean.
FRAME Map: Tel Aviv to Athens route ribbon, plane icon travelling
MOTION follow the plane icon



1.4 · 6.2s

VO Most of the passengers are Israeli or Jewish. Families, students, pensioners going on holiday.
FRAME Cabin interior, passengers settling in, a child at the window, an old couple sharing a newspaper
MOTION lateral dolly down the aisle



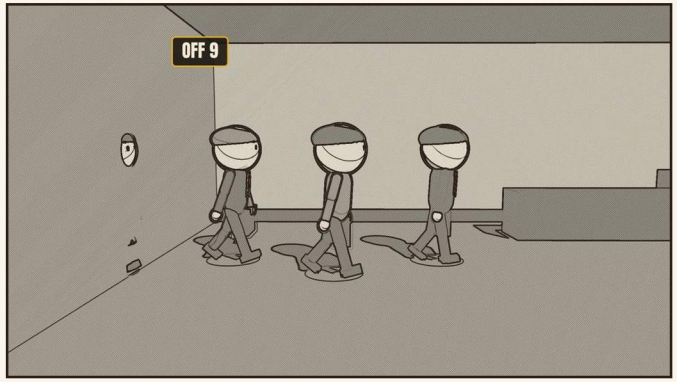
1.5 · 6.6s

VO At half past eleven it lands in Athens. Thirty-eight people get off. Fifty-eight get on.
FRAME Plane at Athens gate, two counters: OFF 38, ON 58
MOTION slow push

1.6 · 9.4s

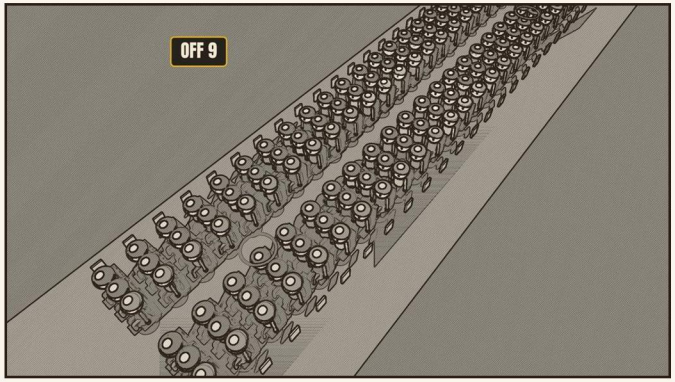
VO Athens airport in 1976 is not careful. On this day, a metal detector is broken, and nobody is watching the X-ray screen.
FRAME Security desk: a detector arch with a dead red light, an empty chair in front of the X-ray monitor
MOTION push in on the empty chair

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 1 FLIGHT 139



1.7 · 6.6s

VO Four of the new passengers walk straight through with pistols and grenades in their bags.
FRAME Four figures carry bags past the empty X-ray desk; bags glow faintly red in an X-ray tint
MOTION tracking shot alongside them



1.8 · 7.0s

VO Two of them sit in first class. Two sit in economy. They look like everyone else.
FRAME Cutaway cabin, two figures highlighted in first class, two in economy
MOTION crane over the cutaway cabin

1.9 · 5.0s

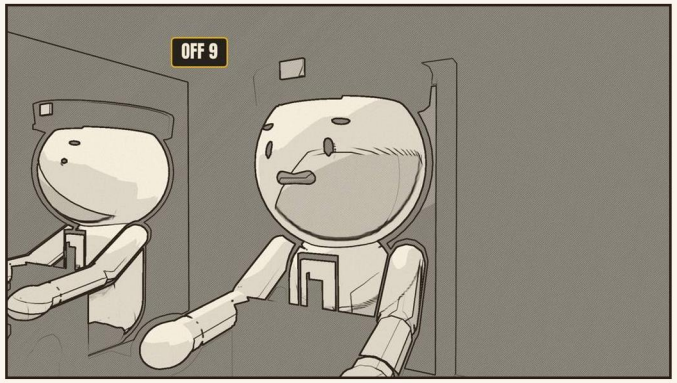
VO At ten past twelve, Flight 139 takes off again for Paris.
FRAME Map: route from Athens heading west
MOTION follow the plane icon

1.10 · 11.8s

VO Eight minutes later, over the Gulf of Corinth, the two in first class stand up. Each has a pistol in one hand and a grenade in the other.
FRAME Silhouettes stand in the first class aisle; weapons shown only as dark shapes, nobody hurt
MOTION slow push from the back of the cabin

1.11 · 9.4s

VO They run toward the cockpit. The crew and the front rows start screaming. At the back, nobody knows what is happening yet.
FRAME Split frame: panic at the front, calm at the back with a passenger reading
MOTION lateral dolly from front to back



1.12 · 6.2s

VO In the cockpit are the captain, Michel Bacos, the co-pilot, and the flight engineer.
FRAME Cockpit, three crew figures; name callout on the captain
MOTION push in on Bacos

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 1 FLIGHT 139

1.13 · 5.0s

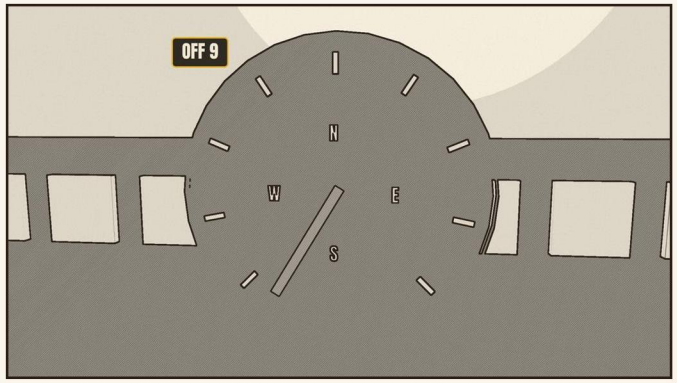
VO Bacos hears the screams and sends the engineer out to look.
FRAME Engineer stands, unlatches the cockpit door
MOTION over-the-shoulder from Bacos

1.14 · 7.8s

VO The door opens, and a man is standing right there, with a gun pointed at the engineer's head.
FRAME Door opens on a silhouette with a raised dark shape; cut before any contact
MOTION quick push, then hold

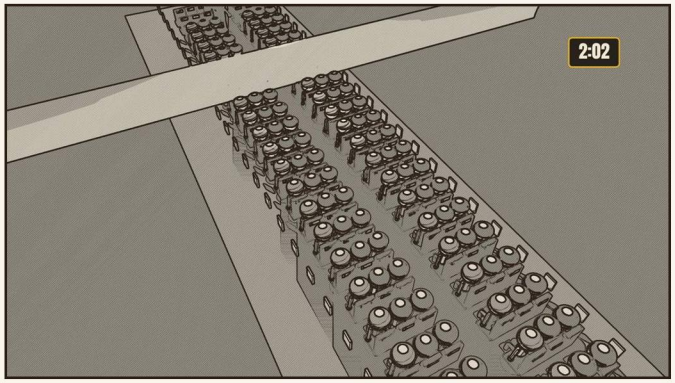
1.15 · 7.0s

VO He is Wilfried Böse, a German. He walks into the cockpit and takes the co-pilot's seat.
FRAME Böse in the co-pilot seat; name callout in red second line
MOTION slow orbit around the seat



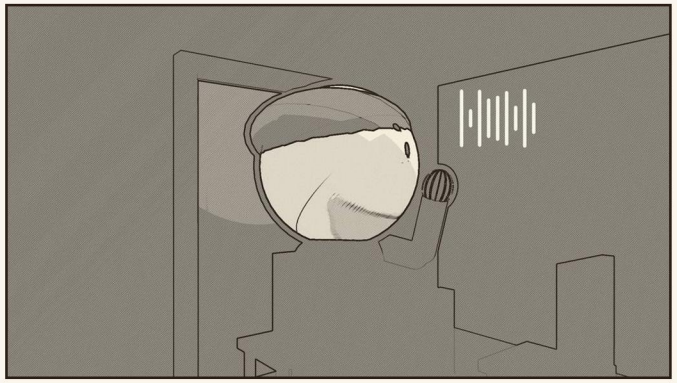
1.16 · 7.0s

VO He tells Bacos to turn the plane south. Do what I say, and nobody gets hurt.
FRAME Böse points at the compass; heading needle swings from west to south
MOTION close on the attitude and heading display



1.17 · 8.6s

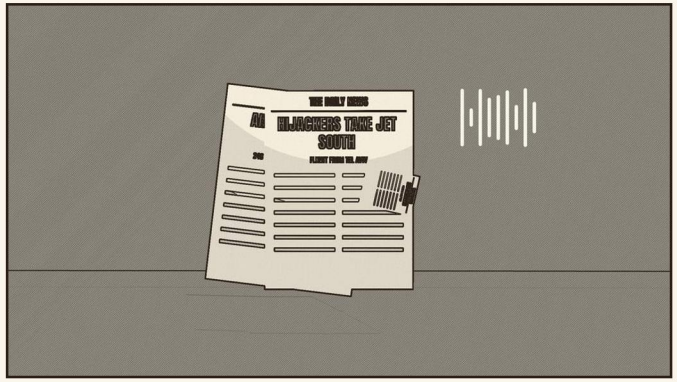
VO At the back, the other two hijackers take control of economy. In about three minutes, the whole plane is theirs.
FRAME Two hijackers at the back of economy; a "3:00" stopwatch runs down
MOTION crane over the cabin cutaway



1.18 · 11.0s

VO Then Böse picks up the captain's microphone. He says the plane is hijacked, and that he is the captain now. He says it again in French.
FRAME Böse with the cabin microphone; speech waveform icon over the cabin
MOTION push in on the microphone

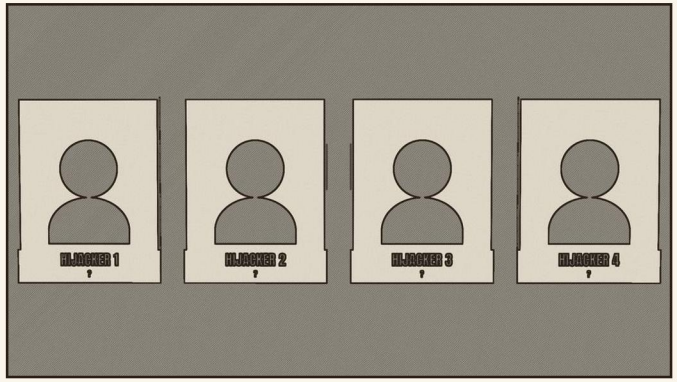
OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 1 FLIGHT 139



1.19 · 6.2s

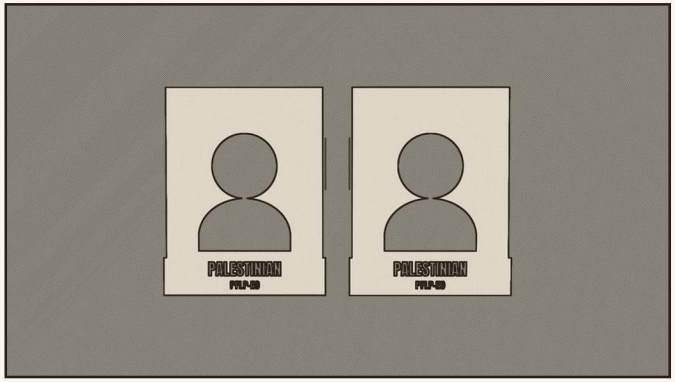
VO By the next morning, Flight 139 is on front pages all over the world.
FRAME Newspapers spin in and stack: "AIR FRANCE JET HIJACKED", "246 HOSTAGES"
MOTION newspaper spins, slow push

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 2 THE HIJACKERS



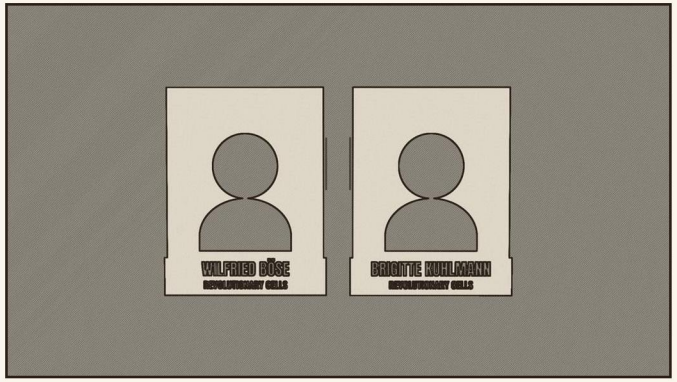
2.1 · 5.0s

VO Meanwhile, the world asks a question. Who are these four people?
FRAME Four silhouette cards flip in a row
MOTION card flips, slow push



2.2 · 10.2s

VO Two are Palestinian, from a group that split off the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine. It is called the PFLP External Operations.
FRAME Two silhouette cards with the group name
MOTION card highlight

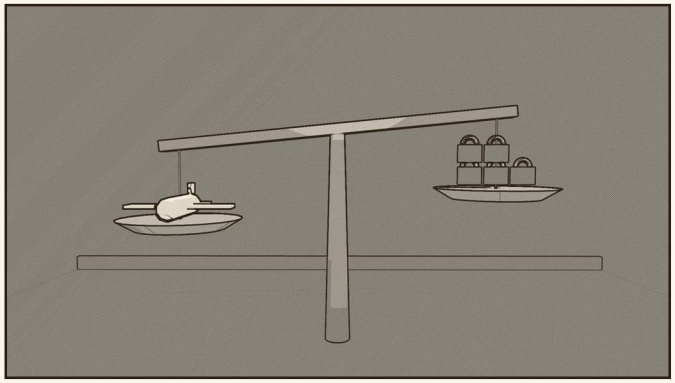


2.3 · 7.8s

VO The other two are German. Wilfried Böse and Brigitte Kuhlmann, from a far-left group called the Revolutionary Cells.
FRAME Böse and Kuhlmann cards, generic house-style figures
MOTION card highlight

2.4 · 8.6s

VO Many of their comrades are in prison. Most of them in Israel, others in France, West Germany, Switzerland and Kenya.
FRAME Map with prison icons; Israel glows brightest
MOTION camera drifts across Europe, the Middle East and Africa



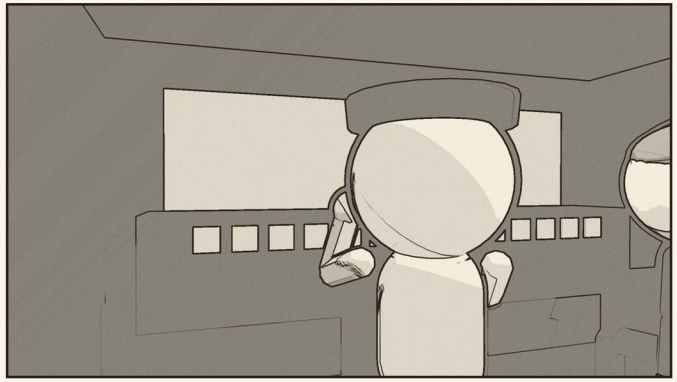
2.5 · 7.8s

VO The plan is simple and cruel. Take a plane full of hostages and trade them for the prisoners.
FRAME Plane icon on one side of a scale, prison padlocks on the other
MOTION scale tips slowly

2.6 · 6.2s

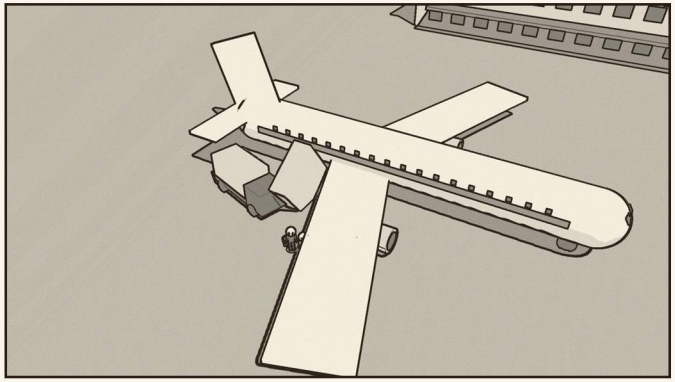
VO At three in the afternoon the jet reaches Libya. The fuel is running low.
FRAME Map: plane icon reaching Benghazi; fuel gauge needle near empty
MOTION follow plane, push in on Benghazi

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 2 THE HIJACKERS



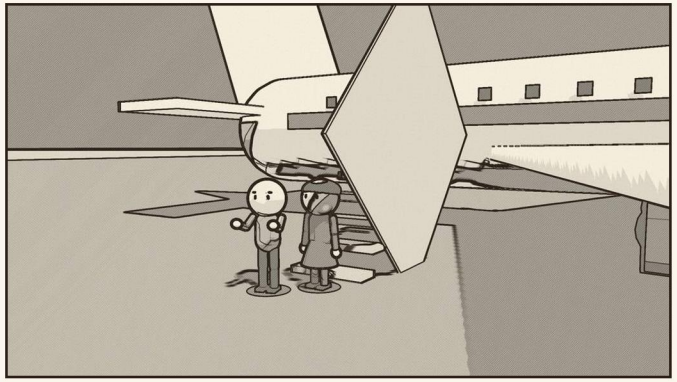
2.7 · 7.4s

VO Bacos tells the control tower in Benghazi it is land here or crash. Libya lets them land.
FRAME Cockpit radio exchange, tower silhouette through the window
MOTION over-the-shoulder at the radio



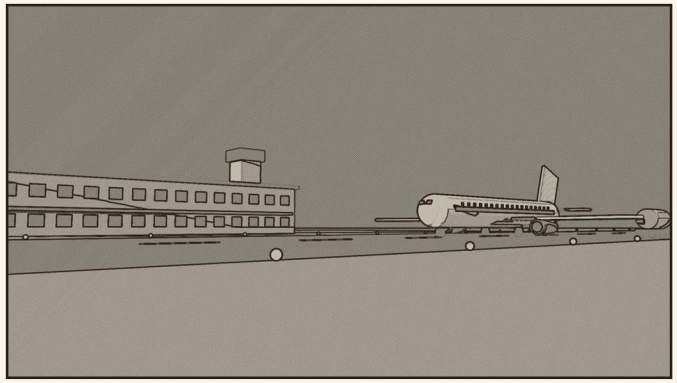
2.8 · 8.2s

VO On the ground, the hijackers relax. They walk off the plane and meet Libyan officials. Passengers are given food.
FRAME Plane on hot tarmac, hijackers chatting with officials, trays passed into the cabin
MOTION wide crane down



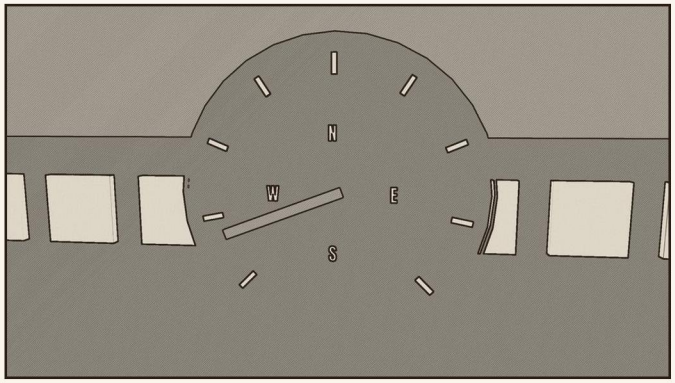
2.9 · 13.4s

VO One passenger, a young woman, tells them she is pregnant and losing her baby. They let her go. She was not really losing the baby. It was a trick, and it worked.
FRAME A woman helped down the stairs; a small "her claim at the time" chip
MOTION slow push



2.10 · 6.6s

VO After about seven hours and a full tank of fuel, the plane takes off again.
FRAME Fuel truck pulls away, jet takes off at dusk
MOTION low angle takeoff



2.11 · 5.4s

VO Soon after takeoff, Böse tells the captain to fly south. To Uganda.
FRAME Heading needle swings south again
MOTION close on the instruments

2.12 · 6.6s

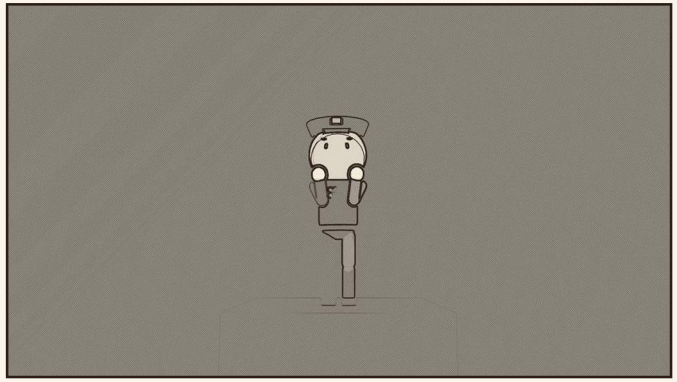
VO When the cabin hears the word Uganda, the fear gets worse. Especially for the Israelis.
FRAME Passengers' faces, worried brows, a hand gripping an armrest
MOTION slow lateral dolly

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 2 THE HIJACKERS

2.13 · 6.6s

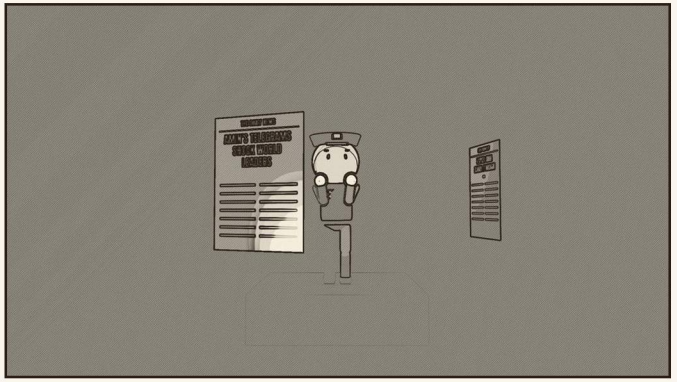
VO Nobody knows what will happen next. And not knowing is its own kind of fear.
FRAME Dark cabin, reading lights going off one by one
MOTION slow push down the aisle

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 3 IDI AMIN'S AIRPORT



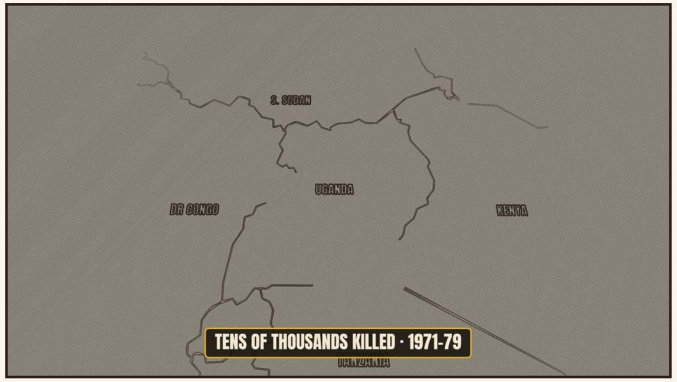
3.1 · 4.2s

VO Meanwhile, Uganda's president is waiting for them. Idi Amin.
FRAME Statue-like portrait of Amin in uniform with medals, lit from below
MOTION slow push up the portrait



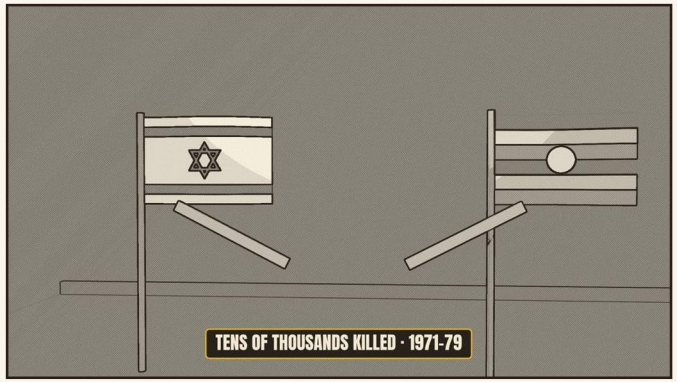
3.2 · 9.8s

VO Amin was famous all over the world, and not for good reasons. He was loud, unpredictable, and he did not follow the rules.
FRAME Newspaper headlines about Amin spin around the portrait
MOTION orbit



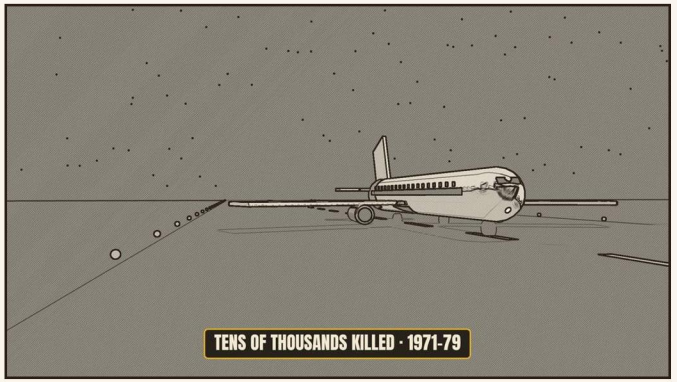
3.3 · 7.4s

VO Since he took power in 1971, tens of thousands of Ugandans had been killed under his rule.
FRAME Dark map of Uganda, a slow counter "TENS OF THOUSANDS"; no bodies shown
MOTION slow sink and desaturate



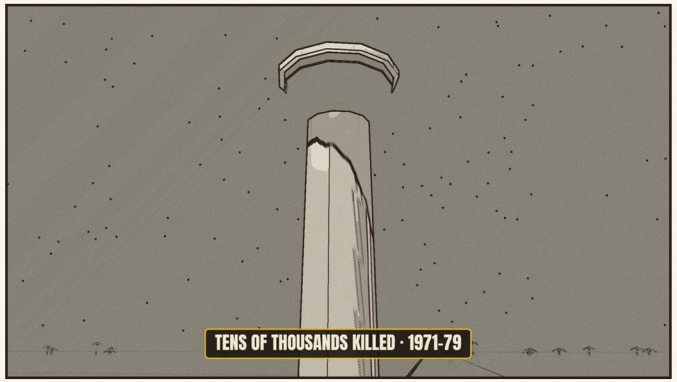
3.4 · 5.8s

VO He had also broken off relations with Israel and turned openly against it.
FRAME Israeli and Ugandan flags; a torn ribbon between them
MOTION push in on the tear



3.5 · 8.2s

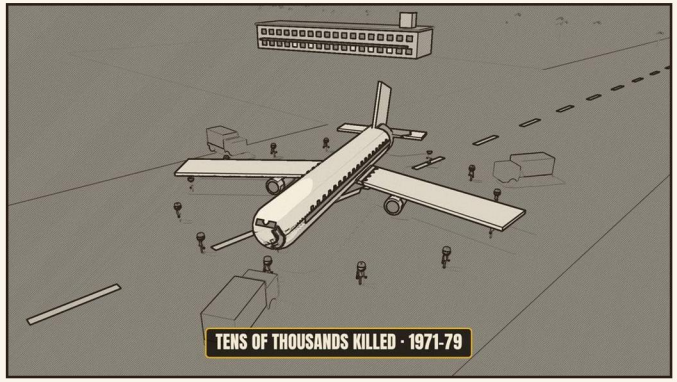
VO At about quarter past three in the morning on 28 June, Flight 139 lands at Entebbe, Uganda's main airport.
FRAME Jet lands on a dark runway, landing lights on
MOTION low runway angle



3.6 · 7.8s

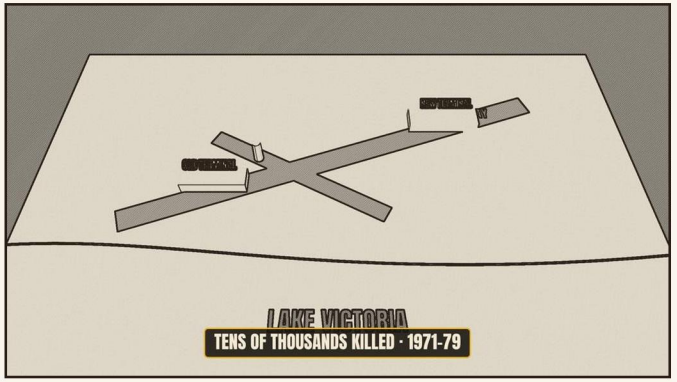
VO The control tower lets it land with no argument. Many later asked if Amin knew it was coming.
FRAME Tower with a lit window; chip "never proven"
MOTION slow push on the tower

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 3 IDI AMIN'S AIRPORT



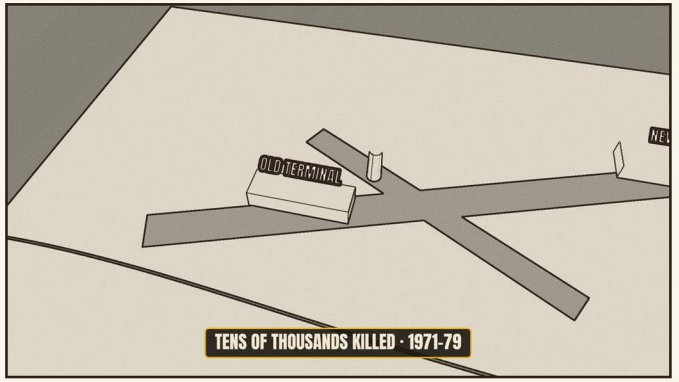
3.7 · 5.8s

VO Ugandan soldiers surround the jet. Trucks, cars and armed men on every side.
FRAME Soldiers and trucks ring the plane in floodlight
MOTION crane up and around



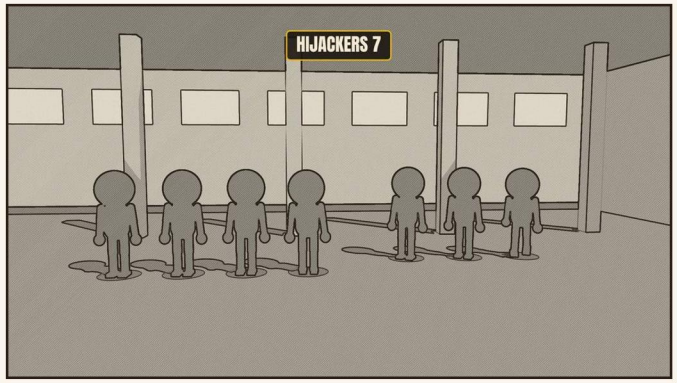
3.8 · 7.4s

VO Entebbe has two terminals. A new one, and an old one that is hardly used any more.
FRAME Airport map: new terminal, old terminal, runways, Lake Victoria to the south
MOTION top-down push in, labels pop



3.9 · 4.6s

VO Remember the old terminal. Everything that happens next happens there.
FRAME Old terminal glows gold on the map
MOTION push in on the old terminal

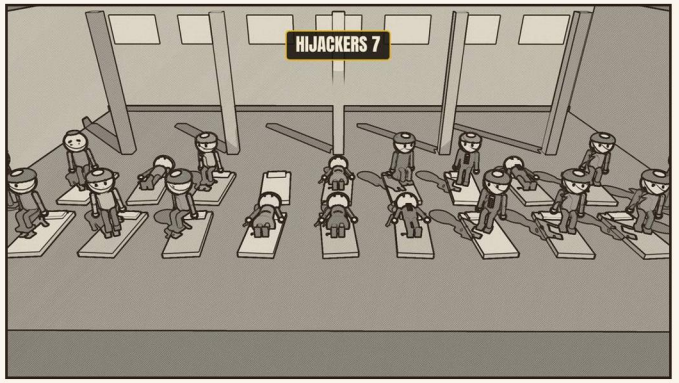


3.10 · 9.8s

VO In the old terminal, the hijackers are joined by more men already waiting in Uganda. There are now at least seven of them.
FRAME Three new silhouettes step out from the shadows; counter 4 to 7
MOTION slow lateral dolly

3.11 · 8.2s

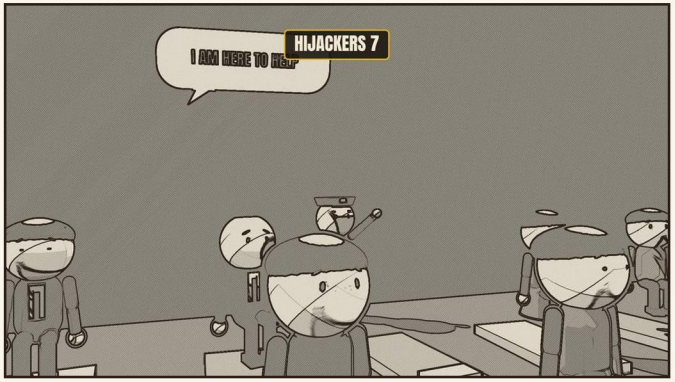
VO The passengers walk in a line from the plane to the old terminal, between Ugandan soldiers and the hijackers.
FRAME A long line of passengers walking across the apron at dawn, guards on both sides
MOTION tracking shot alongside the line



3.12 · 7.4s

VO They are put in the main hall. When the hijackers rest upstairs, Ugandan soldiers guard the hostages.
FRAME Hall with mattresses on the floor, soldiers at the doors
MOTION crane down into the hall

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 3 IDI AMIN'S AIRPORT

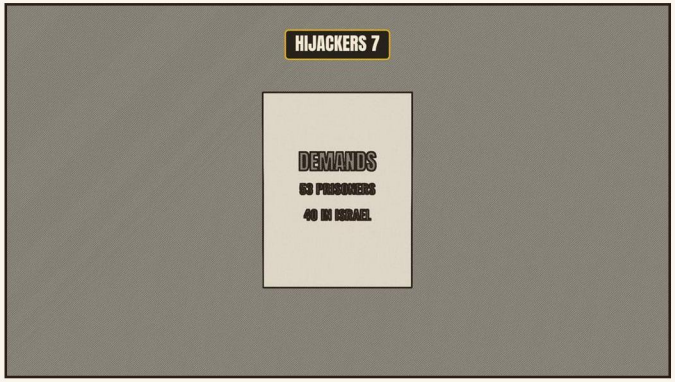


3.13 · 9.4s

VO Then Idi Amin arrives in person and makes a speech. He says he is only a mediator, trying to keep them safe.

FRAME Amin at the front of the hall, hostages looking up; speech bubble "I am here to help"

MOTION slow push from the back of the hall

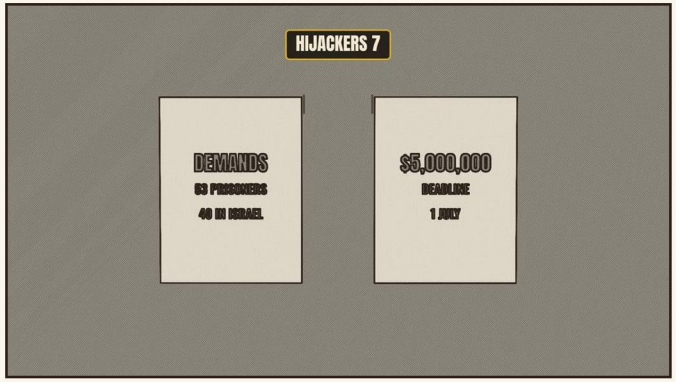


3.14 · 6.2s

VO The hijackers send their demands. Release fifty-three prisoners, forty of them held in Israel.

FRAME Demand card: "53 PRISONERS · 40 IN ISRAEL"

MOTION card slam



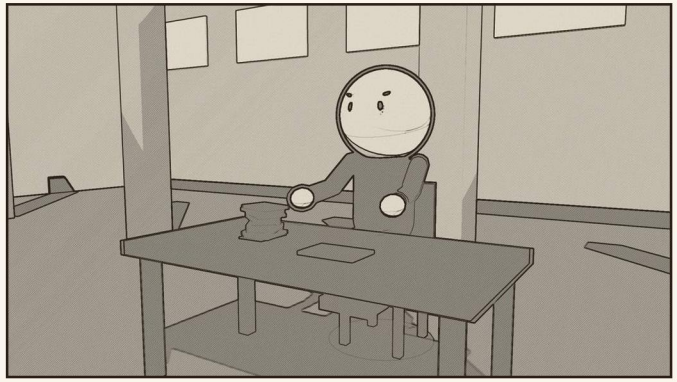
3.15 · 9.0s

VO And five million dollars for the plane. The deadline is 1 July. If it passes, they say, the hostages will die.

FRAME Demand card adds "$5,000,000 · DEADLINE 1 JULY"; clock icon

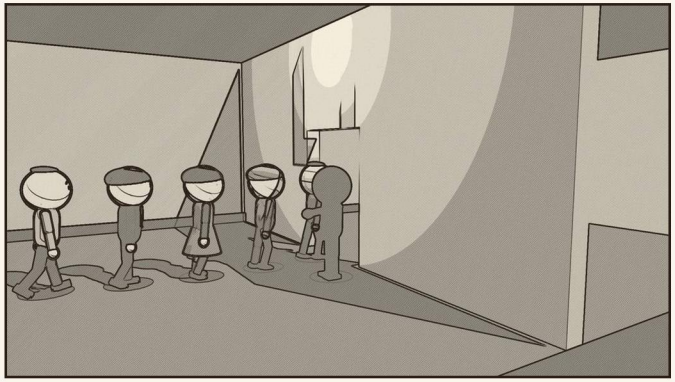
MOTION card slam, clock spins

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 4 THE SELECTION



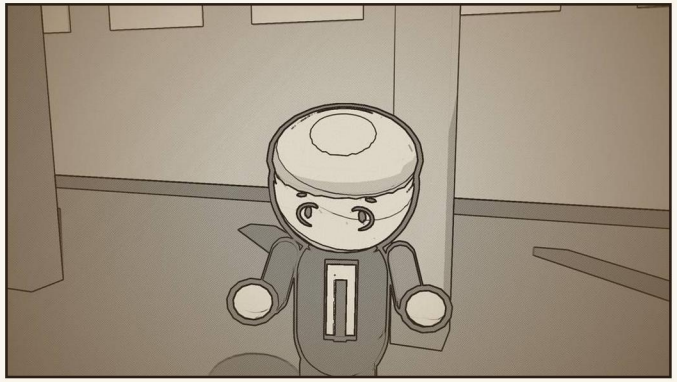
4.1 · 4.2s

VO Meanwhile, the hijackers start reading names from the passports.
FRAME A hijacker at a table with a stack of passports, reading aloud
MOTION over-the-shoulder at the passports



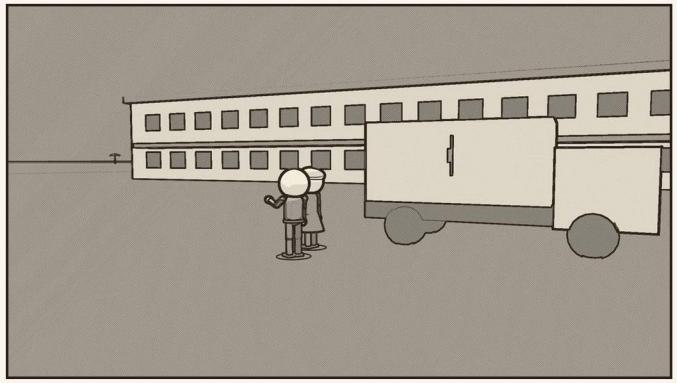
4.2 · 7.0s

VO Israelis and Jewish passengers are moved to a separate room. Even Jewish passengers with other passports.
FRAME Passengers led through a doorway into a second room; the doorway between them
MOTION lateral dolly along the doorway



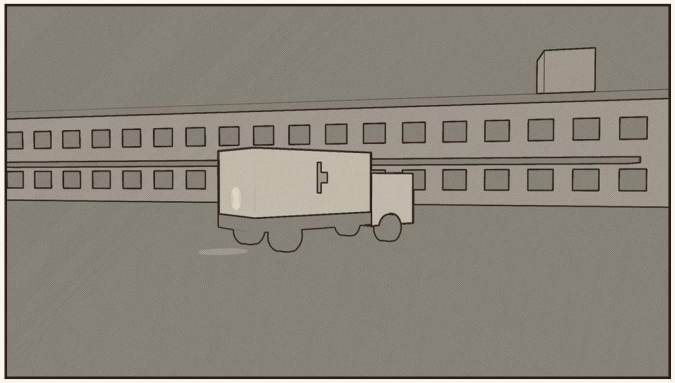
4.3 · 7.0s

VO For many of the older hostages, this moment brings back memories of Europe thirty years earlier.
FRAME An elderly man looks down at his sleeve; soft sepia vignette
MOTION slow push on his face



4.4 · 7.0s

VO One hostage, seventy-five-year-old Dora Bloch, chokes on food and is taken to a hospital in Kampala.
FRAME An elderly woman helped into a Ugandan ambulance
MOTION slow push



4.5 · 5.8s

VO Going to hospital will cost her everything. We will come back to her.
FRAME The ambulance drives off into the dark
MOTION camera holds as tail lights fade

4.6 · 9.0s

VO On 30 June and 1 July, the hijackers let more than a hundred non-Israeli hostages go. They are flown to Paris.
FRAME Groups of hostages walk to a waiting jet; counters show released numbers
MOTION crane up as they board

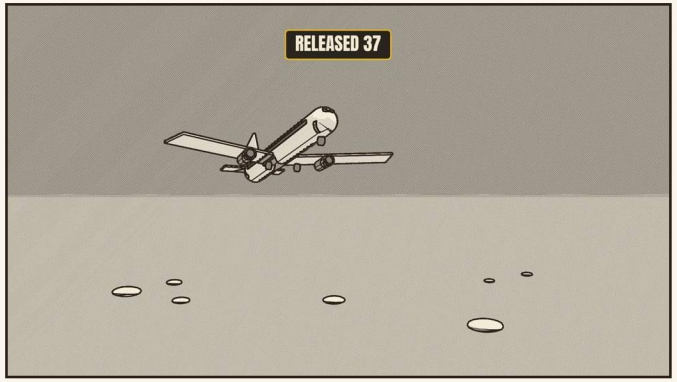
OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 4 THE SELECTION

4.7 · 9.8s

VO The hijackers also offer to free the Air France crew. Captain Bacos refuses. His passengers are still here, so his crew stays too.
FRAME Bacos stands in front of his twelve crew members, arms folded
MOTION slow push on Bacos

4.8 · 5.8s

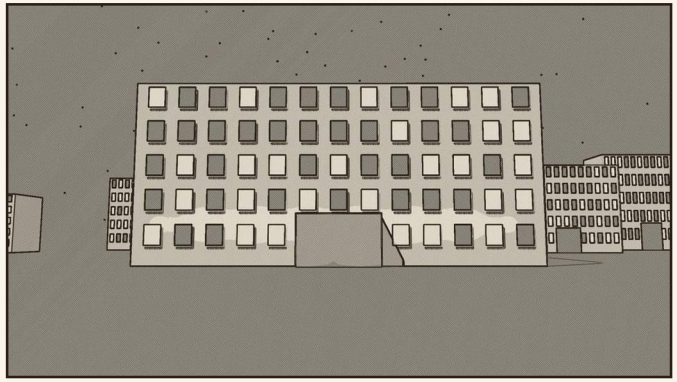
VO A hundred and six hostages are left. Ninety-four passengers, and the twelve crew.
FRAME Hall with the remaining hostages; tally card changes
MOTION slow wide push



4.9 · 7.4s

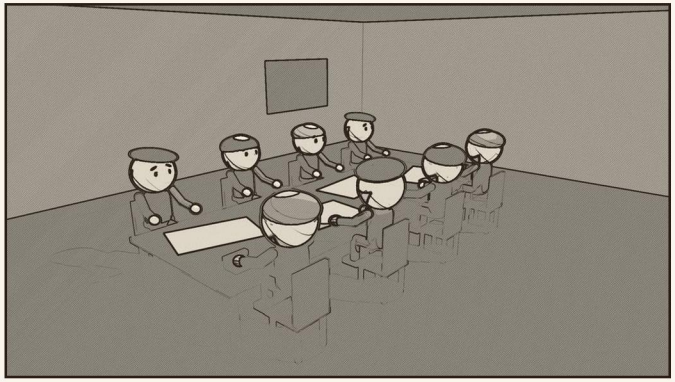
VO Releasing those people in Paris looked like mercy. It turned out to be the hijackers' biggest mistake.
FRAME The plane to Paris climbs away; a red X appears on the hijackers' card
MOTION tracking the plane

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 5 THE WAR ROOM



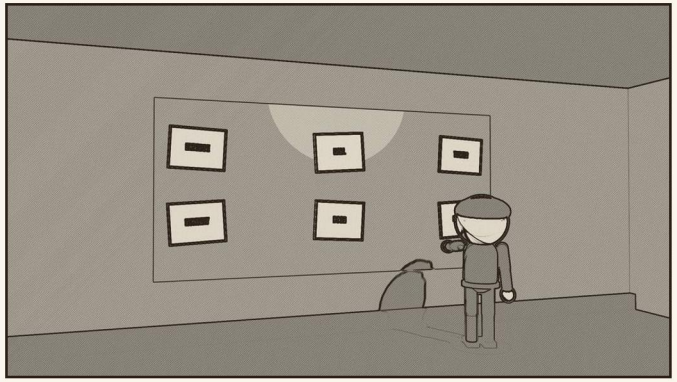
5.1 · 3.8s

VO Meanwhile in Israel, the government has not slept.
FRAME Night in Tel Aviv, a lit government building
MOTION crane down to a window



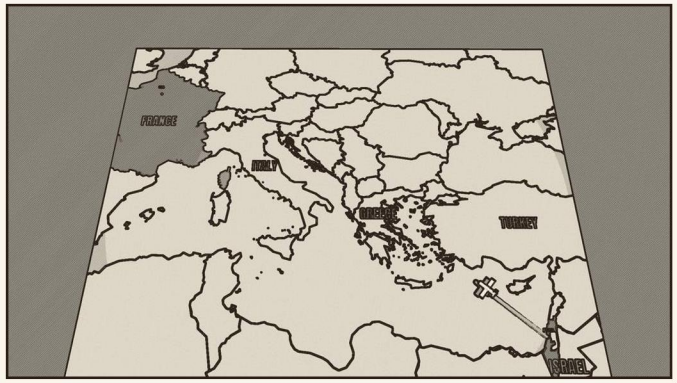
5.2 · 8.6s

VO The army, the Mossad and the Shin Bet meet day and night. Generals, pilots and intelligence officers fill the room.
FRAME War room, figures around a long table with maps and phones
MOTION lateral dolly down the table



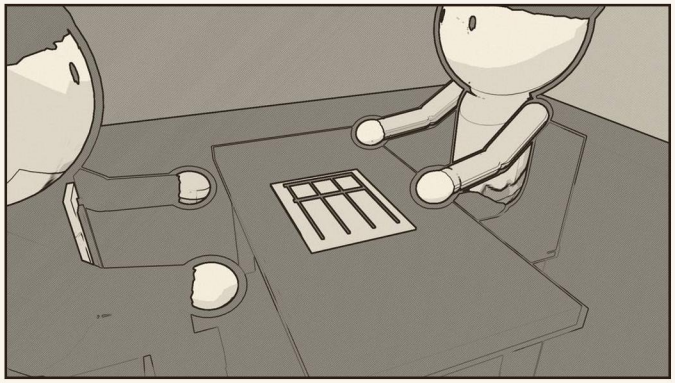
5.3 · 9.4s

VO One team has one job. Find out every detail about the place where the hostages are. Every door, every window, every guard.
FRAME An analyst pins photos and drawings to a wall board
MOTION push in on the board



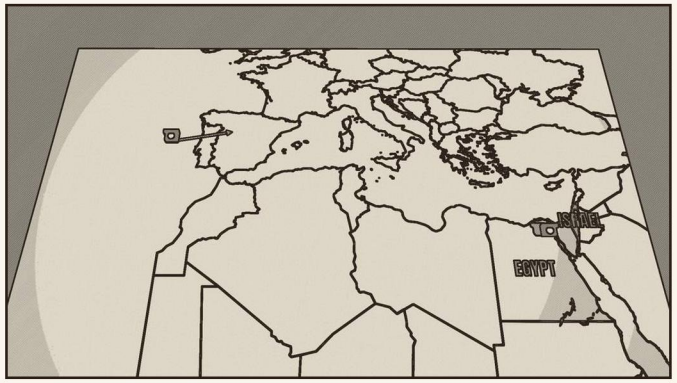
5.4 · 7.4s

VO And then the hijackers' mistake pays off. Israeli agents fly to Paris and meet the released hostages.
FRAME Map: line from Tel Aviv to Paris
MOTION follow the line



5.5 · 8.6s

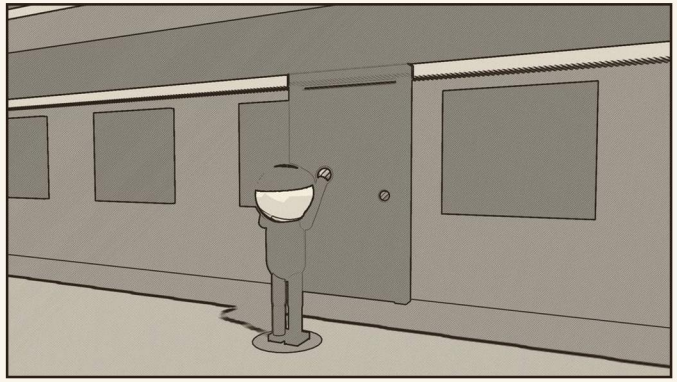
VO They ask them everything. How many hijackers? Where do the Ugandan soldiers stand? Who sleeps where? Which doors are open?
FRAME Interview room in Paris, a released hostage drawing a sketch of the hall
MOTION over-the-shoulder on the sketch



5.6 · 10.2s

VO At the same time, Israel tries to talk its way out. The United States asks Egypt's president, Anwar Sadat, to put pressure on Amin.
FRAME Phones connect between Washington and Cairo
MOTION split screen phone call

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 5 THE WAR ROOM

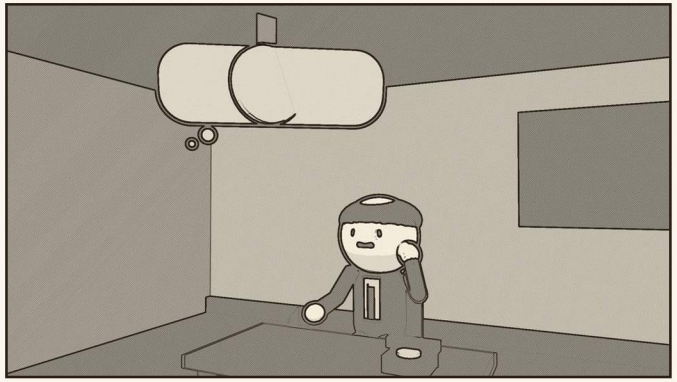


5.7 · 7.0s

VO Even the PLO leader, Yasser Arafat, sends an envoy. The hijackers refuse to speak to him.
FRAME An envoy at the terminal door; the door stays shut
MOTION slow push on the shut door

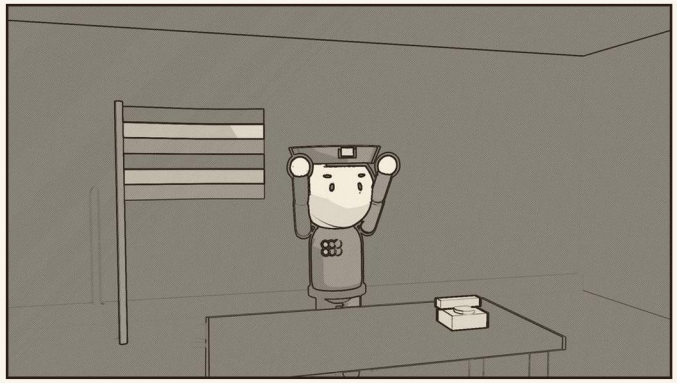
5.8 · 9.0s

VO Israel finds a retired army colonel who knows Amin personally, Baruch Bar-Lev. He calls Amin on the phone again and again.
FRAME Bar-Lev at a desk with a rotary phone; name callout
MOTION push in on the phone



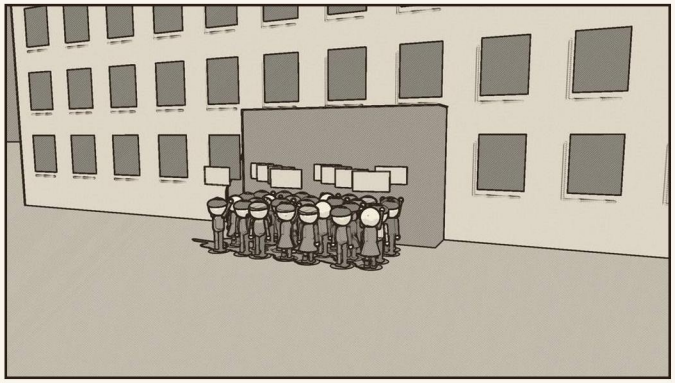
5.9 · 10.6s

VO He tells Amin this is his chance to be a hero. Free the hostages, he says, and you might even win the Nobel Peace Prize.
FRAME A golden medal spins in a thought bubble over the phone
MOTION medal spins, slow push



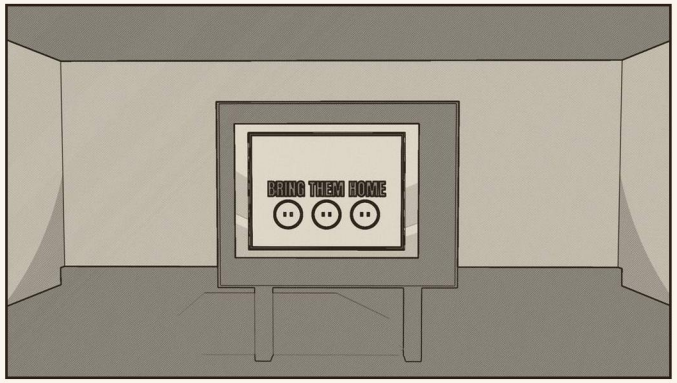
5.10 · 8.2s

VO Amin says it is out of his hands. Give them what they want, or they really will kill everyone.
FRAME Amin on the other end of the line, shrugging
MOTION over-the-shoulder on Amin



5.11 · 8.6s

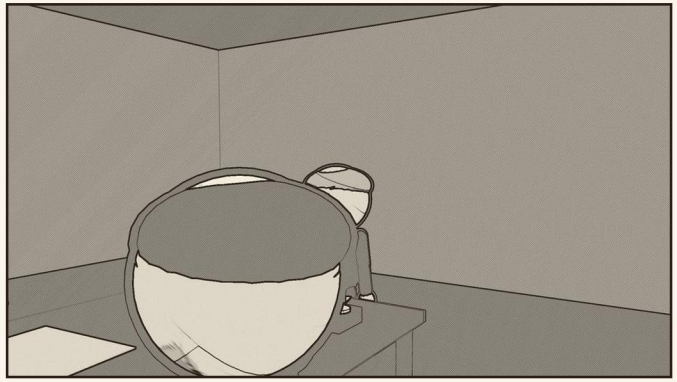
VO At home, the pressure grows by the hour. The hostages' families protest outside government offices and push their way inside.
FRAME Crowd with placards outside a government building; some push through the doors
MOTION wide crane over the crowd



5.12 · 5.8s

VO They are on the news every night. Bring them home, whatever it costs.
FRAME TV set showing family members; placard "BRING THEM HOME"
MOTION push in on the TV

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 5 THE WAR ROOM

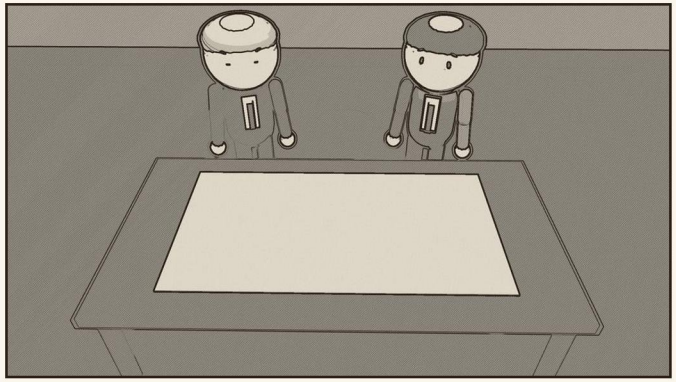


5.13 · 10.2s

VO Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin is ready to negotiate. The hostages are in an enemy country, and he will not risk their lives over prisoners.
FRAME Rabin at the head of the table; name callout
MOTION slow push on Rabin

5.14 · 7.8s

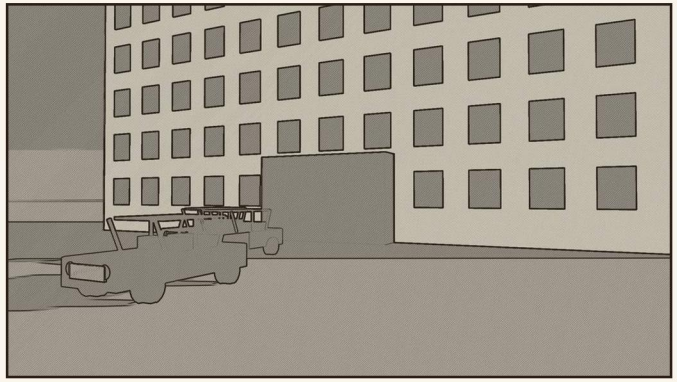
VO His defence minister, Shimon Peres, disagrees. Free terrorists today, he says, and there will be more hijackings tomorrow.
FRAME Peres stands across the table; name callout
MOTION reverse angle, push



5.15 · 6.6s

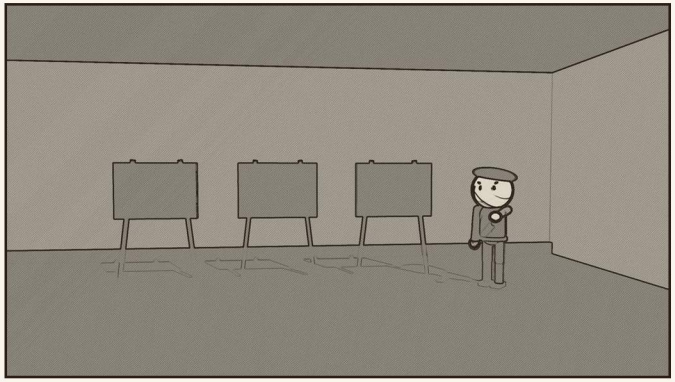
VO They agree on one thing. Bring us a military plan, and then we will decide.
FRAME Both men look at an empty map on the table
MOTION crane over the table

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 6 THREE BAD PLANS



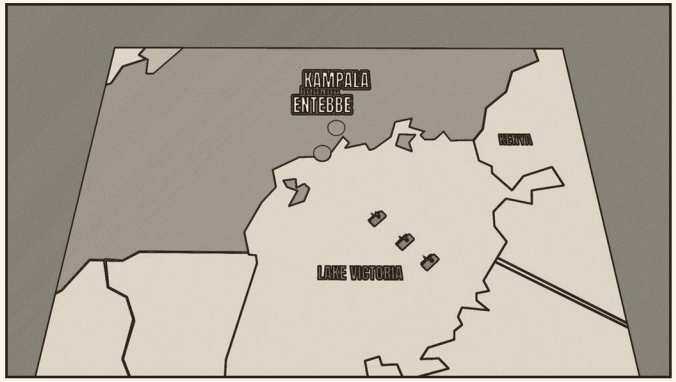
6.1 · 6.6s

VO On the morning of 1 July, the generals meet at army headquarters in Tel Aviv.
FRAME Kirya headquarters at dawn, cars arriving
MOTION crane down



6.2 · 3.4s

VO Brigadier General Dan Shomron brings three plans.
FRAME Shomron at an easel with three covered boards; name callout
MOTION push in

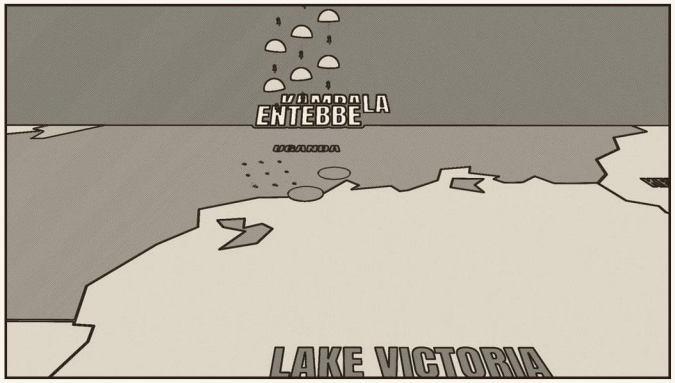


6.3 · 7.0s

VO Plan one. Navy commandos cross Lake Victoria by boat and storm the terminal from the water.
FRAME Map of Lake Victoria; boat icons cross toward Entebbe
MOTION follow the boats

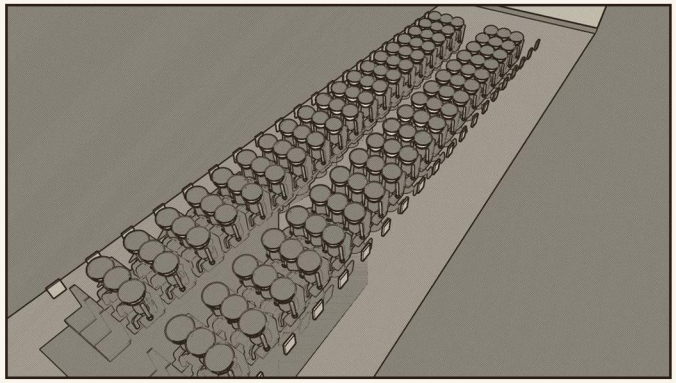
6.4 · 5.4s

VO One problem nobody had written down. Lake Victoria is full of crocodiles.
FRAME Crocodile eyes rise out of the water next to the boat icons; red X stamps the plan
MOTION push in on the crocodile



6.5 · 4.2s

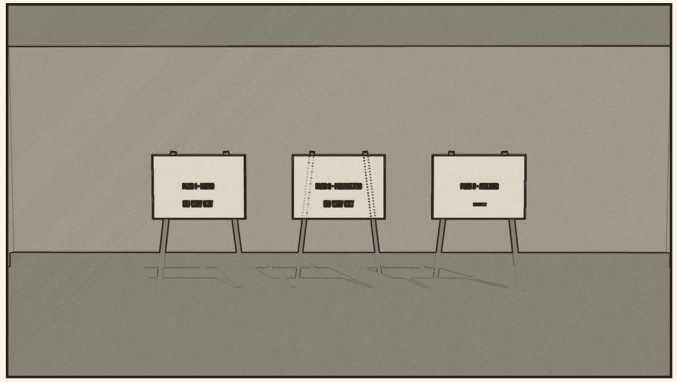
VO Plan two. Drop paratroopers onto the airport at night.
FRAME Parachute icons drift down over the map
MOTION crane following the parachutes



6.6 · 7.8s

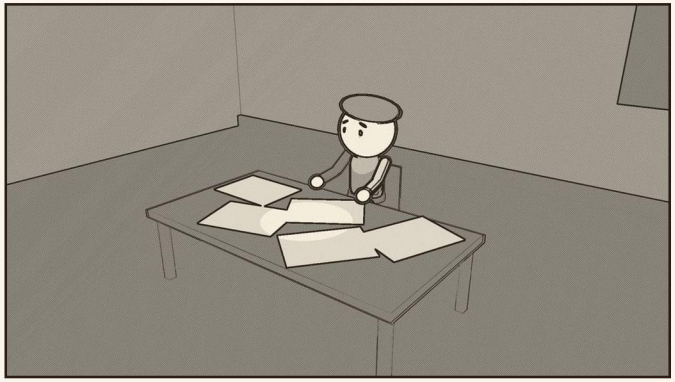
VO Plan three. Hide commandos inside a normal passenger plane and land at Entebbe as if nothing was wrong.
FRAME Cutaway civilian jet full of commandos instead of passengers
MOTION slow orbit

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 6 THREE BAD PLANS



6.7 · 9.8s

VO All three plans get them in. None of them get them out. Every exit depends on Idi Amin helping, and nobody trusts Amin.
FRAME Three boards, each stamped with a red X
MOTION lateral dolly across the boards

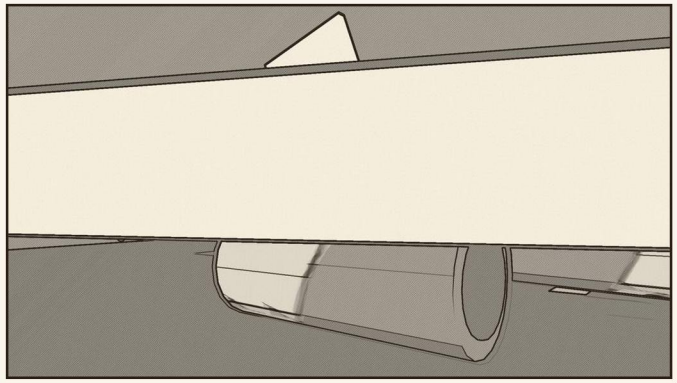


6.8 · 6.2s

VO Shomron asks for more time to build a plan that needs nothing from Uganda.
FRAME Shomron alone at the table, maps spread out
MOTION slow push

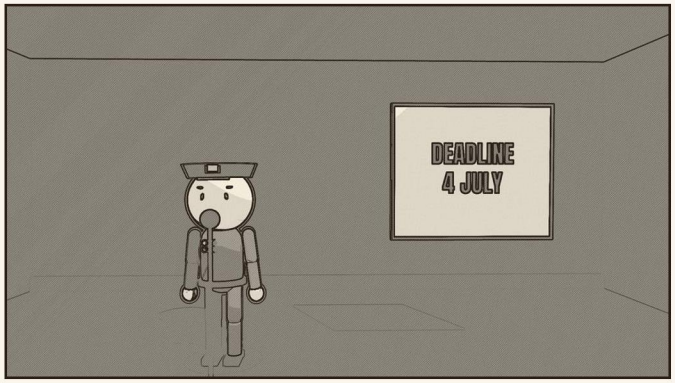
6.9 · 10.2s

VO So Israel buys that time. It tells the hijackers it accepts their demands, but needs a few days to gather prisoners from five countries.
FRAME Telegram slides across a table: "WE ACCEPT. NEED MORE TIME."
MOTION push in on the telegram



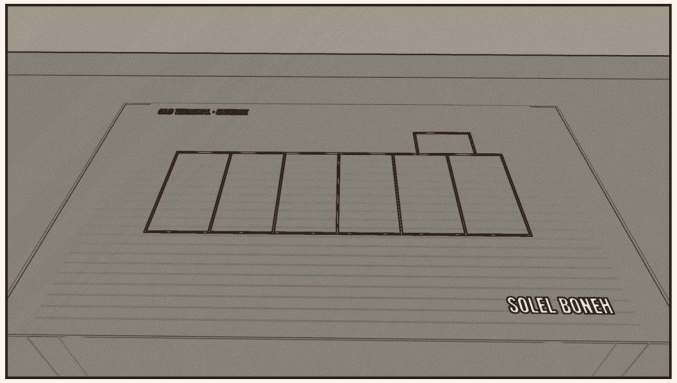
6.10 · 11.4s

VO Amin likes this. He is about to fly to Mauritius to hand over the chair of the Organisation of African Unity, and a delay suits him too.
FRAME Amin boarding a plane, briefcase in hand
MOTION tracking shot



6.11 · 6.6s

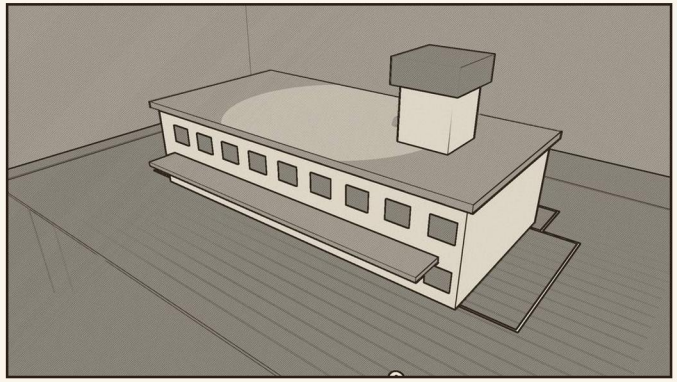
VO The deadline moves to 4 July. Amin goes on the radio and takes the credit.
FRAME Deadline card flips from 1 JULY to 4 JULY; Amin at a microphone
MOTION card flip, push on Amin



6.12 · 9.4s

VO Then the intelligence team finds a gift. An Israeli company, Solel Boneh, built the old terminal at Entebbe in the nineteen seventies.
FRAME Blueprint unrolls on the table, "SOLEL BONEH" in the corner
MOTION push in on the blueprint

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 6 THREE BAD PLANS

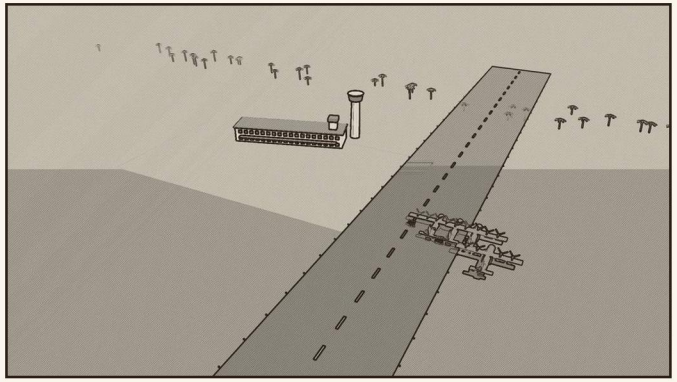


6.13 · 5.4s

VO Its engineers still have the plans. Every room, every corridor, every door.
FRAME Blueprint lines glow and extrude into a 3D terminal model
MOTION orbit the model as it rises

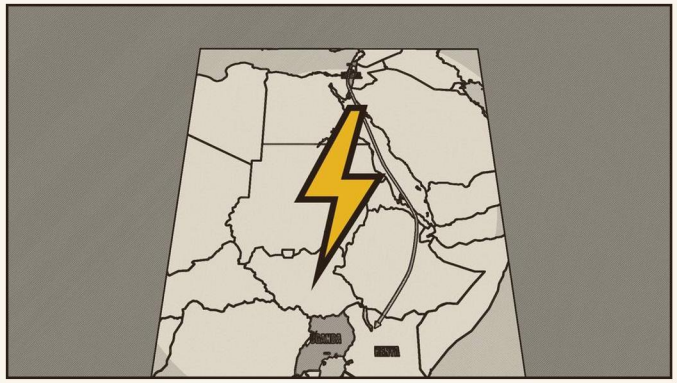
6.14 · 9.4s

VO With the blueprints and the Paris interviews, the soldiers build a copy of the terminal and practise the raid again and again.
FRAME Night training: soldiers run through a wood and canvas mock-up
MOTION tracking alongside runners



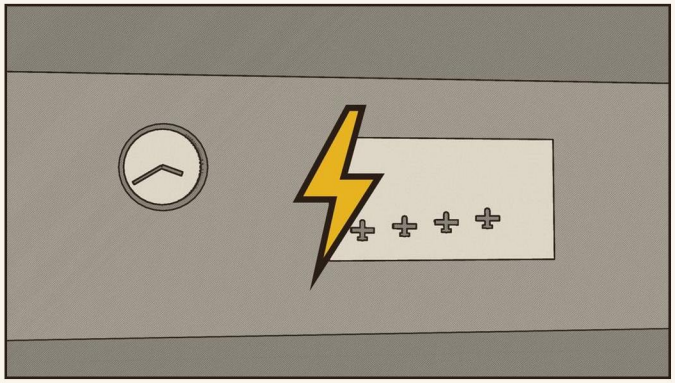
6.15 · 11.8s

VO The final plan is bold. More than a hundred commandos fly to Uganda without asking anyone. They take the whole airport, free the hostages, and fly them home.
FRAME Animated plan on the map: planes land, teams fan out, planes leave
MOTION top-down plan animation



6.16 · 9.0s

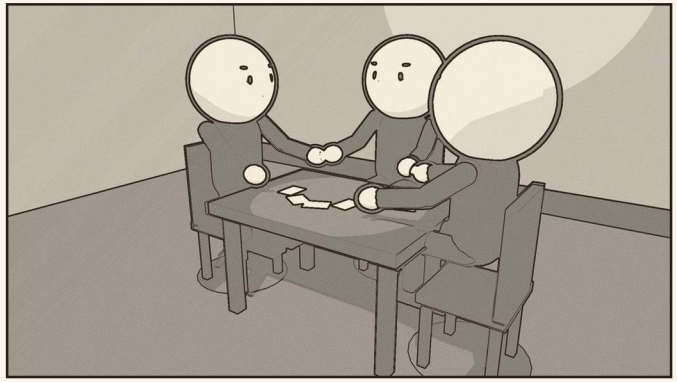
VO The plan only works if everything happens fast. Faster than Uganda's army can react. That is why they call it Thunderbolt.
FRAME Lightning bolt emblem flashes across the map
MOTION title flash



6.17 · 7.0s

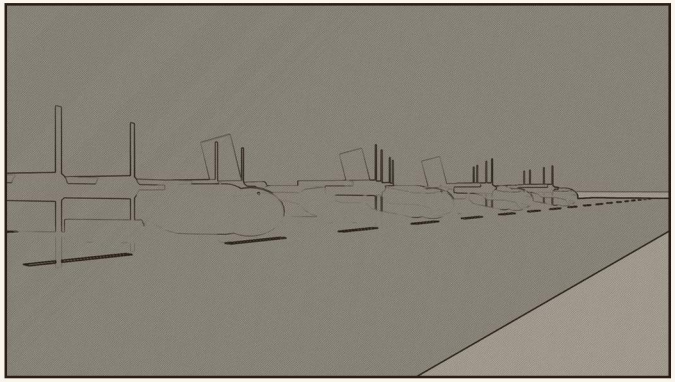
VO On 3 July, the cabinet approves it. By then, the planes are already in the air.
FRAME Clock on the wall; through the window, planes climbing
MOTION push in on the clock

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 7 FOUR HERCULES



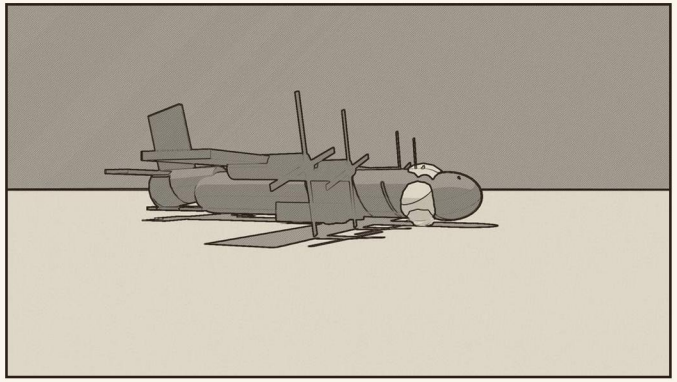
7.1 · 8.2s

VO Meanwhile, at Entebbe, the hijackers are relaxed. In less than a day, they think, they will have their prisoners.
FRAME Hijackers playing cards upstairs in the terminal
MOTION slow push



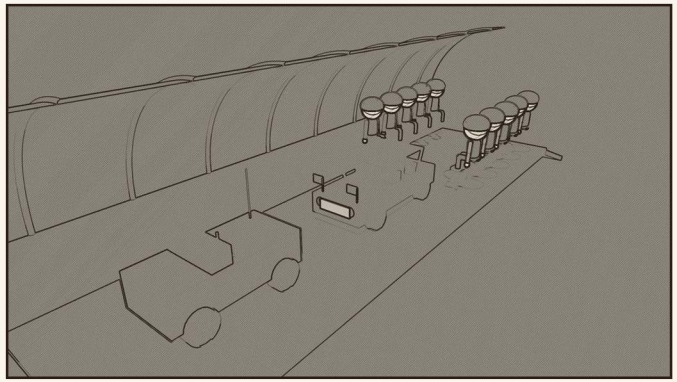
7.2 · 4.6s

VO Israel picks four C-130 Hercules transport planes for the job.
FRAME Four C-130s lined up on an Israeli airbase at sunset
MOTION lateral dolly along the noses



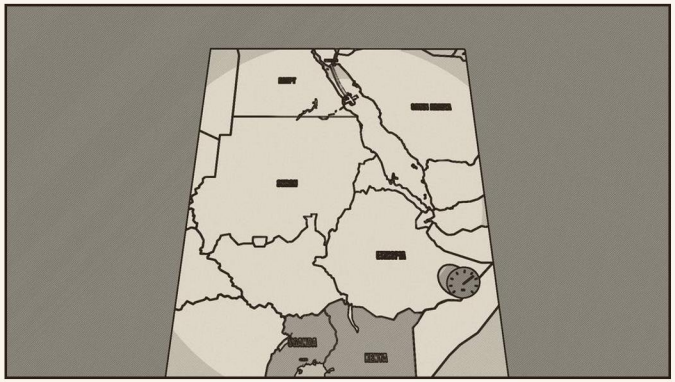
7.3 · 5.8s

VO The Hercules can land on short, rough runways and take off again fast.
FRAME A C-130 does a short landing on a dirt strip, dust cloud
MOTION tracking the landing



7.4 · 7.4s

VO It carries heavy loads, and its back ramp opens so cars and soldiers can roll straight out.
FRAME Cutaway C-130 showing a Mercedes, Land Rovers and soldiers inside
MOTION orbit the cutaway



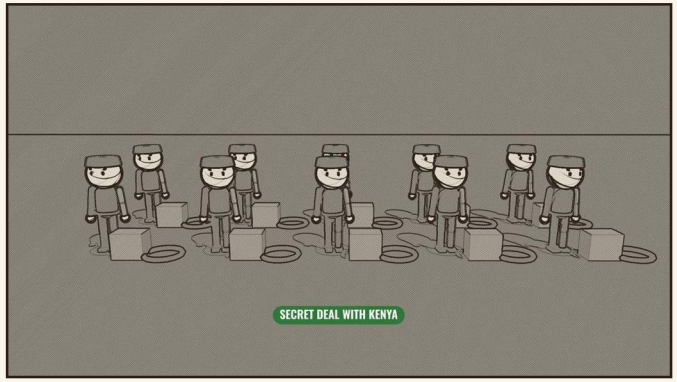
7.5 · 9.0s

VO Israel to Entebbe is more than four thousand kilometres. Even full of fuel, the planes cannot make it home without refuelling.
FRAME Map: route with a fuel gauge running down to empty before Israel
MOTION follow the route

7.6 · 6.2s

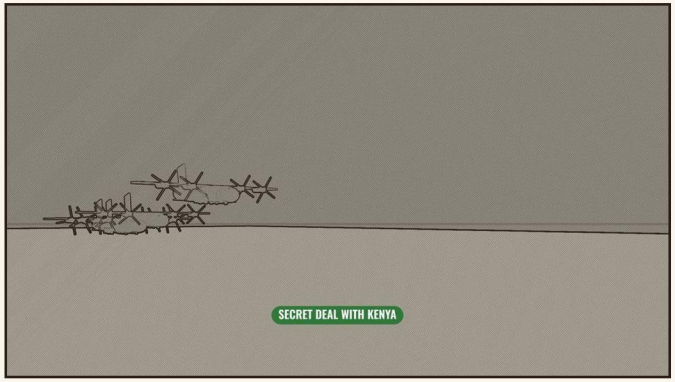
VO So Israel secretly arranges to refuel in Kenya, at Nairobi, on the way back.
FRAME Map: Nairobi glows; secret handshake icon
MOTION push in on Nairobi

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 7 FOUR HERCULES



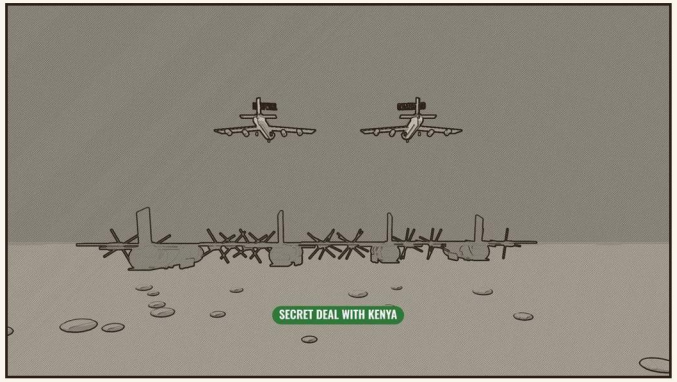
7.7 · 8.2s

VO They also bring a team with portable pumps, ready to steal fuel from Entebbe itself if Kenya says no.
FRAME Ten soldiers with fuel pumps and hoses
MOTION slow push



7.8 · 8.6s

VO In the afternoon of 3 July, the four planes take off from Sharm el-Sheikh, at the tip of the Sinai.
FRAME Planes take off one by one over the sea
MOTION low angle takeoffs



7.9 · 10.2s

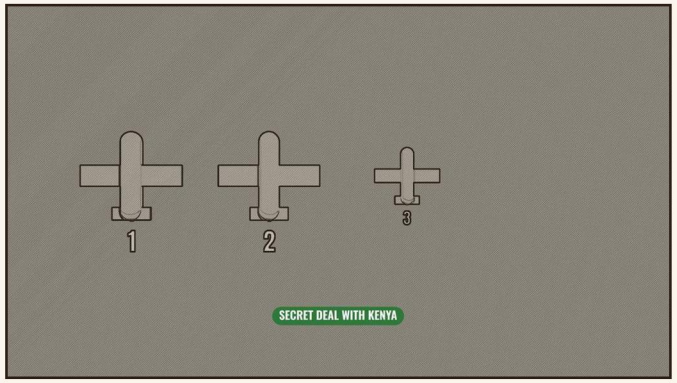
VO Two Boeing 707s follow. One is a flying hospital that waits in Nairobi. The other is a flying command post that circles over Entebbe.
FRAME Two 707s high above the C-130s; labels "HOSPITAL" and "COMMAND"
MOTION crane up through the clouds

7.10 · 11.4s

VO They fly down the Red Sea along the airline routes, then drop very low, just above the waves, below the radars of Egypt, Sudan and Saudi Arabia.
FRAME Map: route ribbon dips; radar circles sweep and miss the planes
MOTION follow ribbon, radar sweeps

7.11 · 4.6s

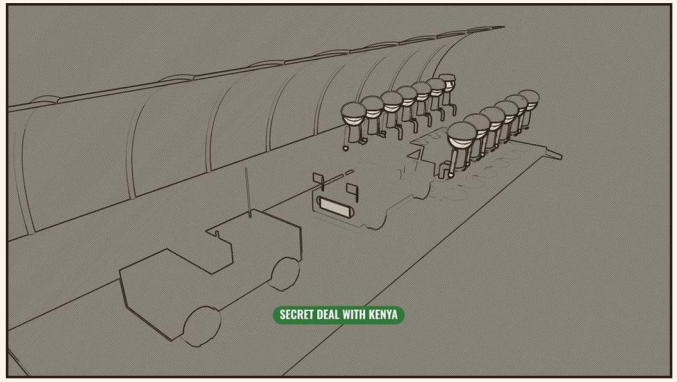
VO Over Ethiopia, over Kenya, then across Lake Victoria toward Entebbe.
FRAME Map: ribbon crosses Ethiopia and Kenya to the lake
MOTION crane down to the lake



7.12 · 3.0s

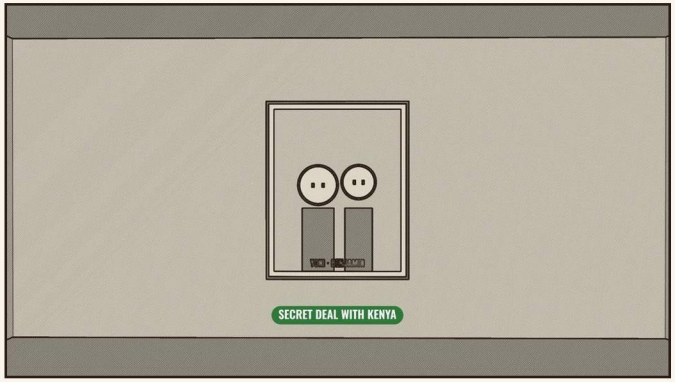
VO Each plane has its own job.
FRAME Four plane icons with numbers 1 to 4
MOTION card flips

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 7 FOUR HERCULES



7.13 · 7.8s

VO Plane one carries the assault team. Twenty-nine commandos from Israel's elite unit, Sayeret Matkal, led by Yoni Netanyahu.
FRAME Cutaway of plane one, the convoy and the 29 men
MOTION push in

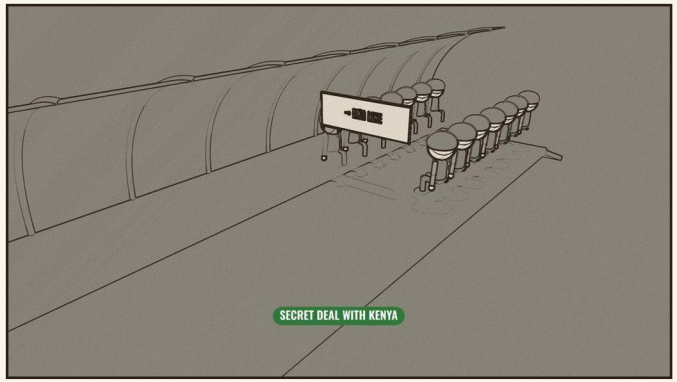


7.14 · 7.8s

VO Yoni is the older brother of a man who will one day become Israel's prime minister, Benjamin Netanyahu.
FRAME Two brothers in a family photo frame
MOTION slow push on the frame

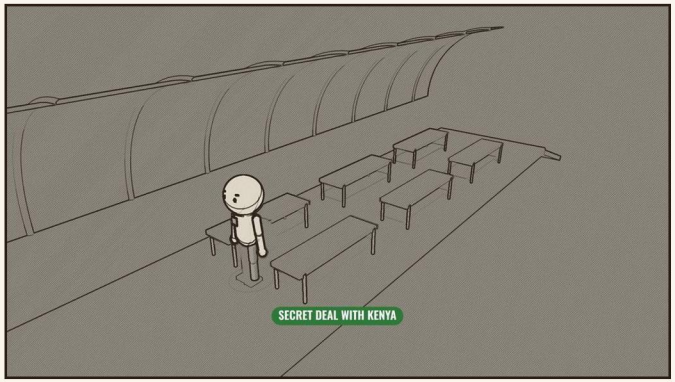
7.15 · 7.0s

VO Plane two carries a team to take the new terminal and hold off the Ugandan army.
FRAME Plane two cutaway, soldiers with flags pointing to the new terminal
MOTION lateral dolly



7.16 · 7.4s

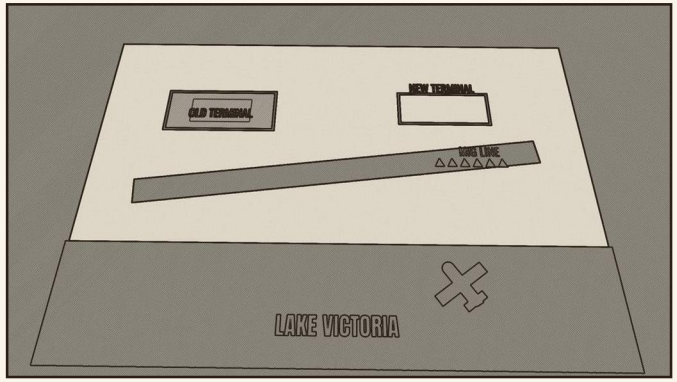
VO Plane three carries the team that will destroy Uganda's fighter jets, so nobody can chase them home.
FRAME Plane three cutaway, map arrow to the MiG line
MOTION push in



7.17 · 4.6s

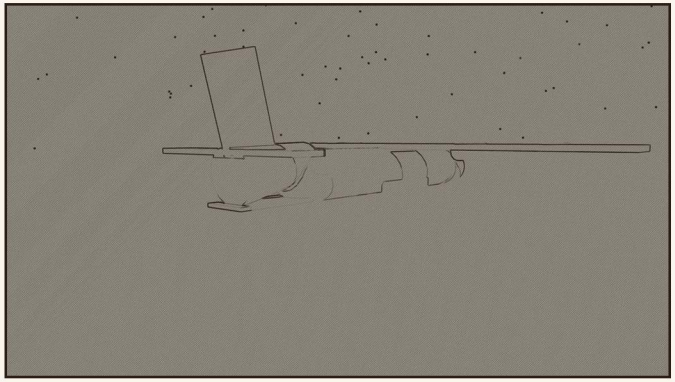
VO Plane four is for the hostages, with doctors on board.
FRAME Plane four with stretchers and a medic
MOTION slow orbit

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 8 THE FAKE MERCEDES



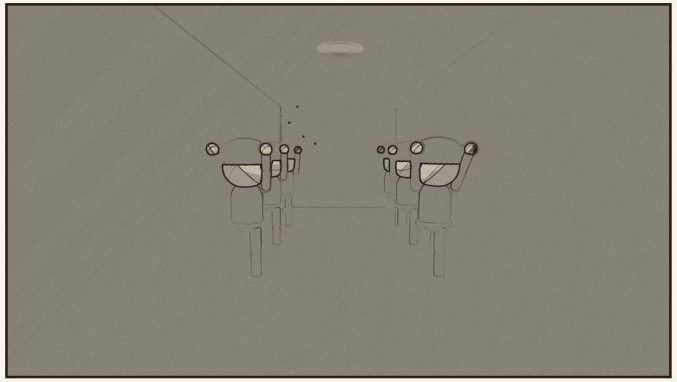
8.1 · 5.0s

VO One minute before eleven at night, the first Hercules reaches Entebbe.
FRAME Airport map with the lead plane icon approaching from the lake
MOTION top-down push



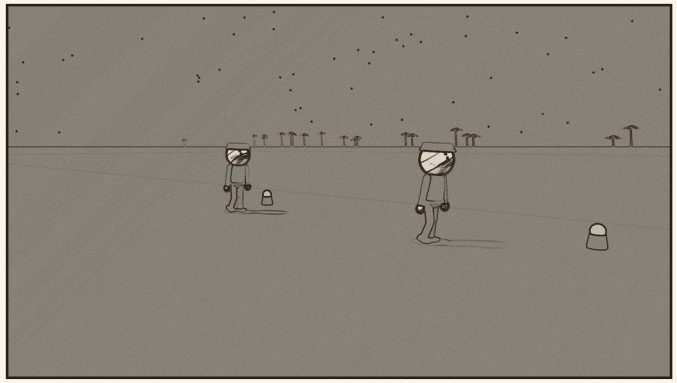
8.2 · 6.6s

VO It comes in with its lights off, two engines shut down to keep it quiet.
FRAME Dark C-130 over the lake, two propellers still
MOTION tracking the plane



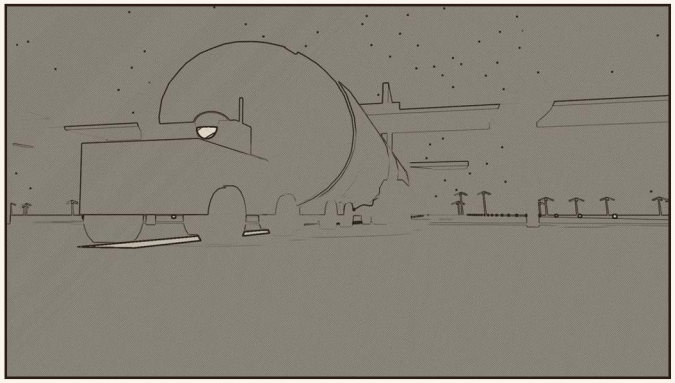
8.3 · 6.2s

VO The ramp opens in the air, so not one second is lost after landing.
FRAME Ramp lowering in flight, soldiers holding on inside
MOTION interior shot looking out the open ramp



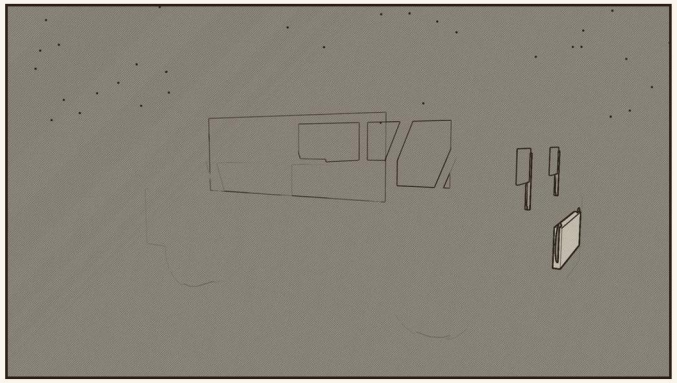
8.4 · 10.2s

VO On the ground, soldiers place battery lights along the runway, so the next planes can land even if Uganda turns the runway lights off.
FRAME Soldiers place small lamps along the runway edge
MOTION lateral dolly along the lamps



8.5 · 4.6s

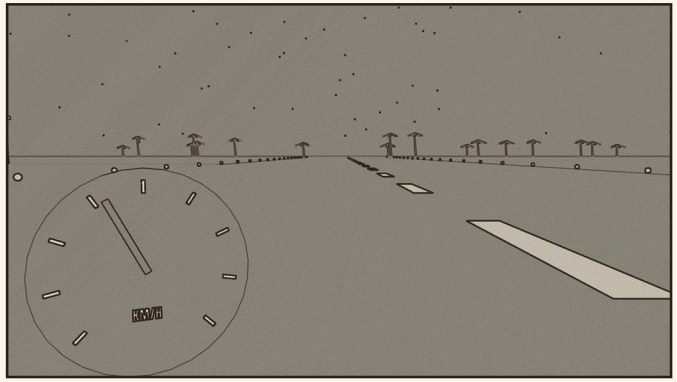
VO Out comes the black Mercedes and the two Land Rovers.
FRAME Ramp down, convoy rolls out
MOTION low angle



8.6 · 11.4s

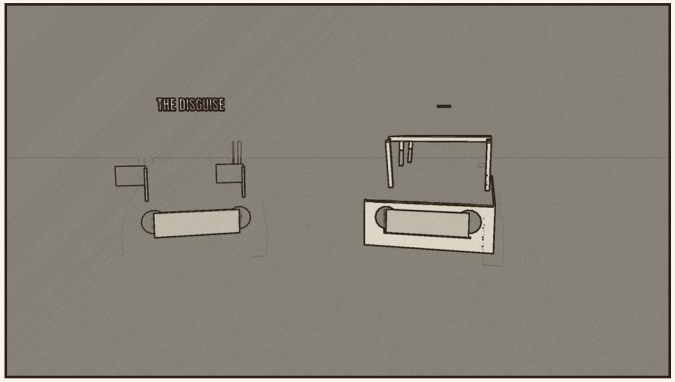
VO Amin always arrived at the airport in a black Mercedes with an escort. So the Israelis copied it. Same car, same flags, same kind of number plates.
FRAME Close detail on the flag and plate; side by side with a photo of the real convoy
MOTION push in on the flag

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 8 THE FAKE MERCEDES



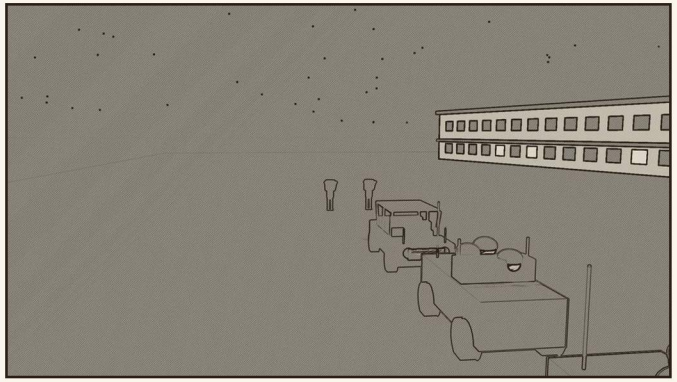
8.7 · 6.6s

VO Then they drive slowly toward the old terminal, at the speed Amin's convoy usually drove.
FRAME Convoy driving through the dark, speedometer 40 km/h
MOTION tracking alongside the convoy



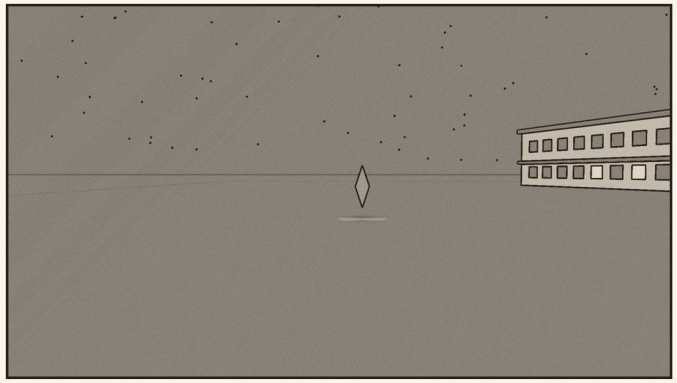
8.8 · 8.6s

VO But they did not know one thing. A few days earlier, Amin had bought a new Mercedes. A white one.
FRAME Split frame: black Mercedes and white Mercedes; red X on the black one
MOTION push in on the white car



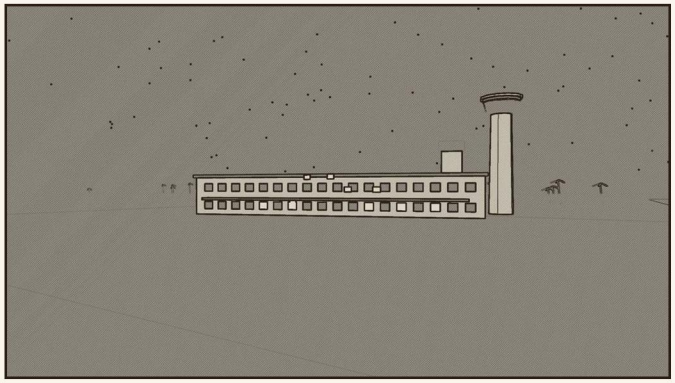
8.9 · 9.4s

VO Three hundred metres from the terminal, two Ugandan sentries see a black Mercedes and know something is wrong. They raise their rifles.
FRAME Two sentries step into the headlights, rifles raised
MOTION slow push from behind the convoy



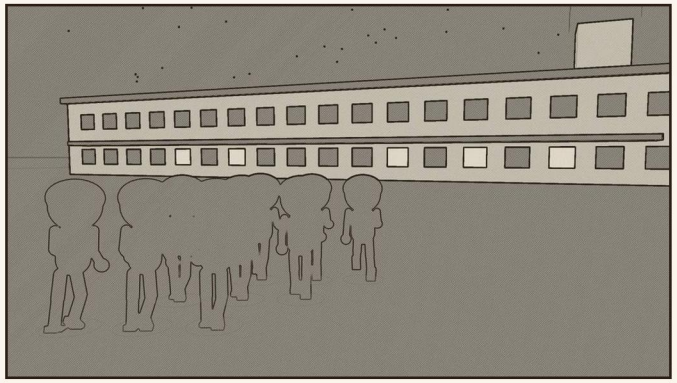
8.10 · 11.0s

VO The commandos had orders not to fire on Ugandans. But the moment has come. A silenced shot, then a loud one from the Land Rover behind.
FRAME Cut to black on the first shot; a flash lights the dark
MOTION cut to black, flash



8.11 · 5.0s

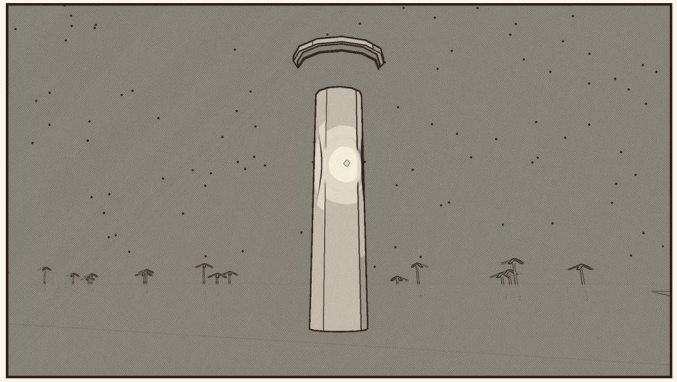
VO The loud shot echoes across the runway. The surprise is gone.
FRAME Wide shot of the airport, lights flicking on in windows
MOTION slow crane up



8.12 · 5.0s

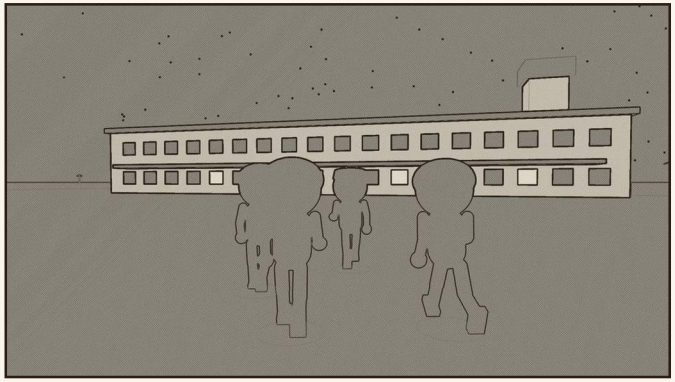
VO They leave the cars and run the last three hundred metres.
FRAME Silhouettes running toward the terminal
MOTION tracking at running speed

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 8 THE FAKE MERCEDES



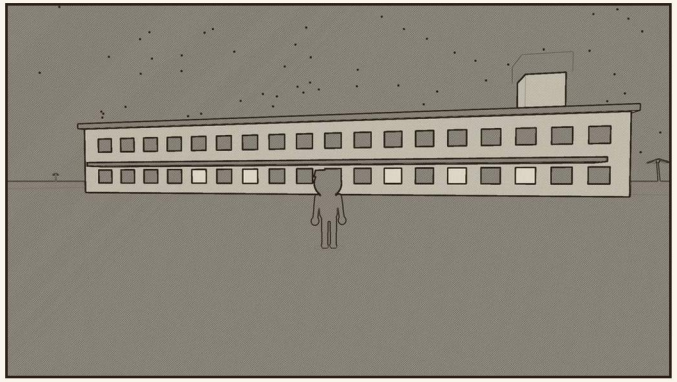
8.13 · 7.4s

VO Soldiers on top of the old control tower open fire. Two teams stay back to fight them.
FRAME Muzzle flashes high on the tower as small star flashes; nobody shown hit
MOTION push in on the tower



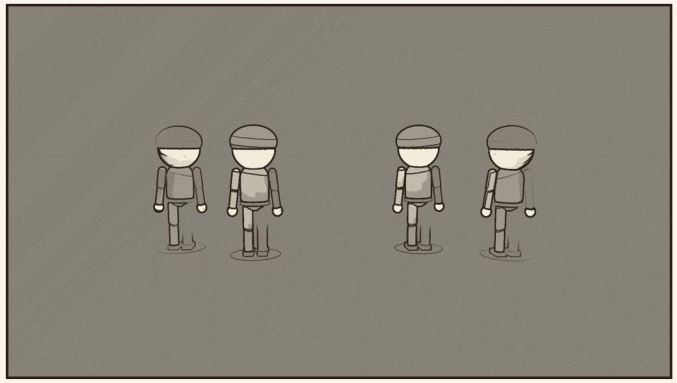
8.14 · 5.0s

VO Yoni's team keeps running toward the main hall. Speed is everything.
FRAME Yoni at the front of the team, silhouette
MOTION tracking close behind



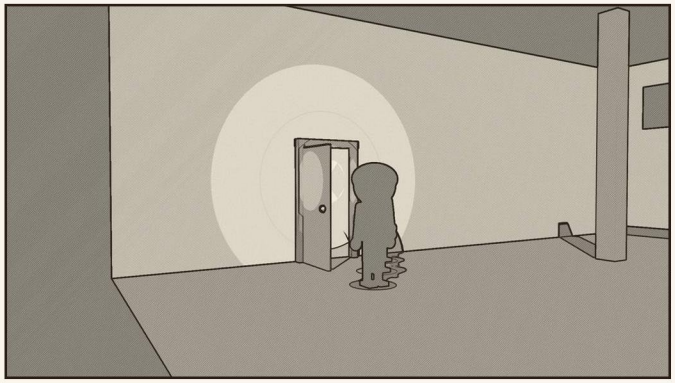
8.15 · 7.8s

VO Outside the terminal, Yoni is hit by fire from the Ugandan soldiers. He falls. The others keep going.
FRAME Yoni's silhouette stops; cut to black for one beat
MOTION cut to black



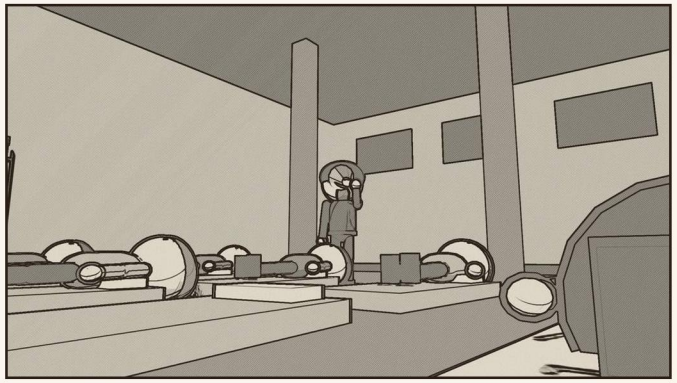
8.16 · 7.0s

VO The man who led the raid is the first to fall. The raid has barely begun.
FRAME The empty spot in the running line, lit by a single lamp
MOTION slow push



8.17 · 10.6s

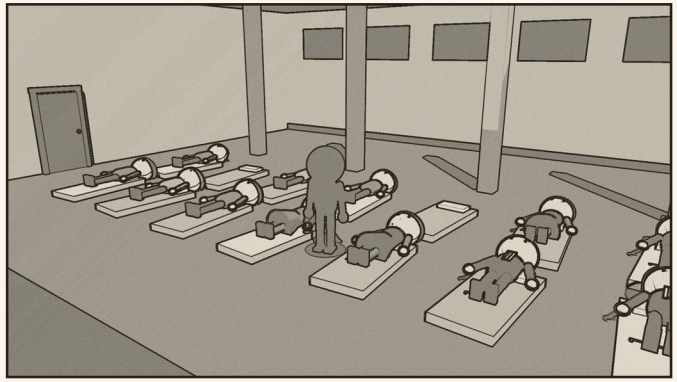
VO At the door, a hijacker steps out, and he is shot. Inside, two more hijackers turn toward the hostages, and the commandos shoot them first.
FRAME Hall doorway lit by flashes, silhouettes only
MOTION cut between flashes



8.18 · 6.2s

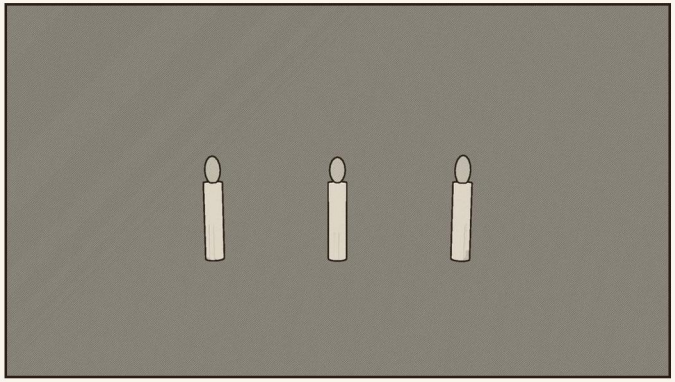
VO The commandos shout through a megaphone in Hebrew and English. Stay down. Stay down.
FRAME A commando with a megaphone; hostages flat on the mattresses
MOTION low angle from the floor

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 8 THE FAKE MERCEDES



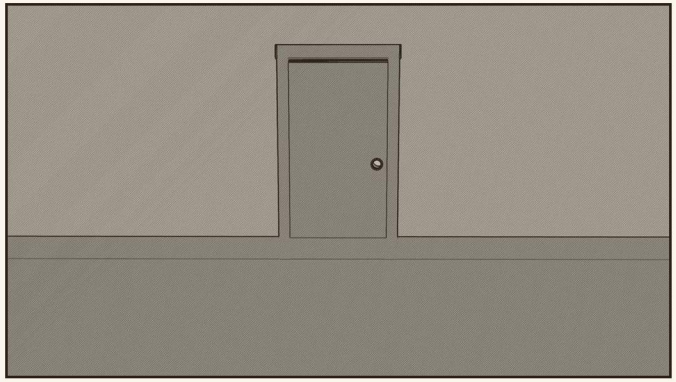
8.19 · 7.8s

VO One young hostage stands up. In the dark, a commando takes him for a hijacker. He is killed.
FRAME A standing silhouette among the lying hostages; cut to black
MOTION cut to black



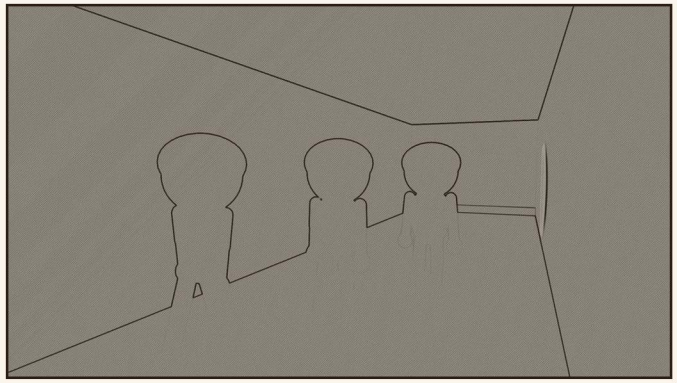
8.20 · 3.0s

VO Three hostages die in the crossfire.
FRAME Three candles on black
MOTION slow push



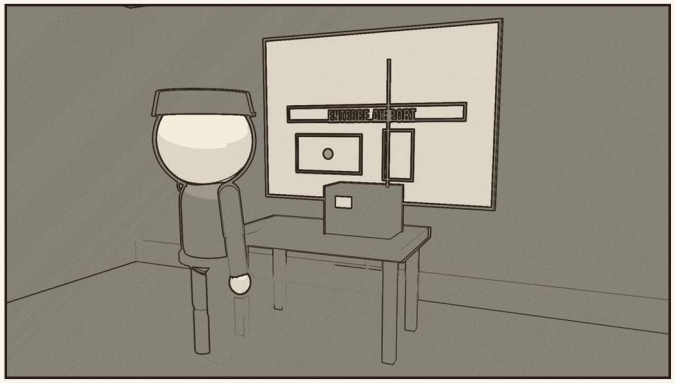
8.21 · 7.4s

VO The hostages point to a side room. The last hijackers are hiding there. The commandos go in.
FRAME Door to the side room, a flash under the door
MOTION push in on the door



8.22 · 6.2s

VO Every hijacker in the terminal is dead. The commandos check every room and floor.
FRAME Corridor with torch beams sweeping
MOTION lateral dolly with the torches



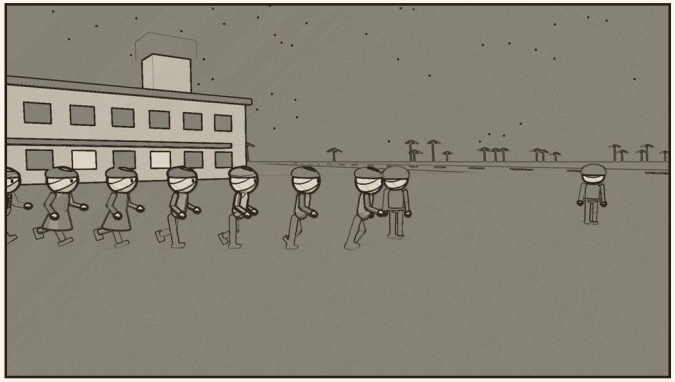
8.23 · 6.2s

VO Then the radio call goes out. We have the hostages. We are coming out.
FRAME Commando at a radio, map of the airport behind him
MOTION push in on the radio

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 9 HOME

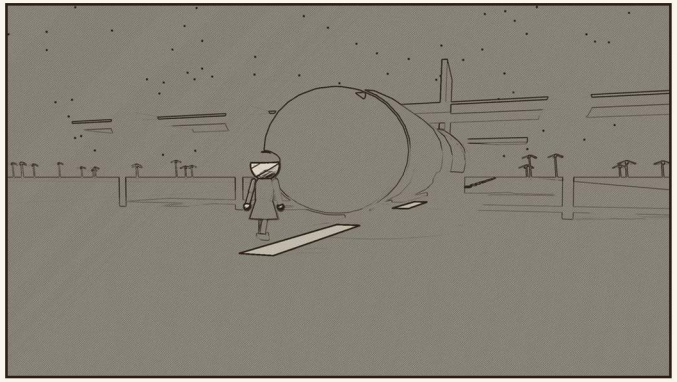
9.1 · 3.8s

VO Meanwhile, the fighting is still going on outside.
FRAME Wide shot of the airport with distant flashes
MOTION slow crane



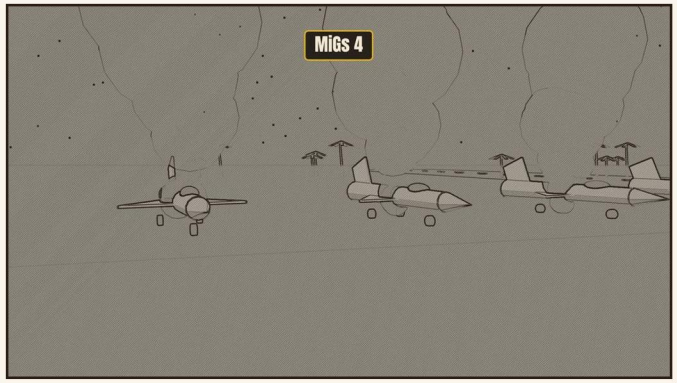
9.2 · 6.2s

VO The hostages run from the terminal to the planes, with commandos on both sides.
FRAME Line of hostages running across the apron, commandos guarding
MOTION tracking alongside the line



9.3 · 3.8s

VO A hundred and two of them are rescued.
FRAME Counter ticks to 102 as the last hostage boards
MOTION push in on the ramp



9.4 · 10.2s

VO On the military side of the airport, the third team destroys Uganda's fighter jets in a row. Eleven MiGs. Nobody can follow them now.
FRAME Line of MiG jets; flashes roll down the row; smoke only, no people
MOTION lateral dolly down the row

9.5 · 7.4s

VO In the fighting, around forty-five Ugandan soldiers are killed. Five commandos are wounded. Only one dies. Yoni.
FRAME Memorial card with numbers, no images of bodies
MOTION slow push

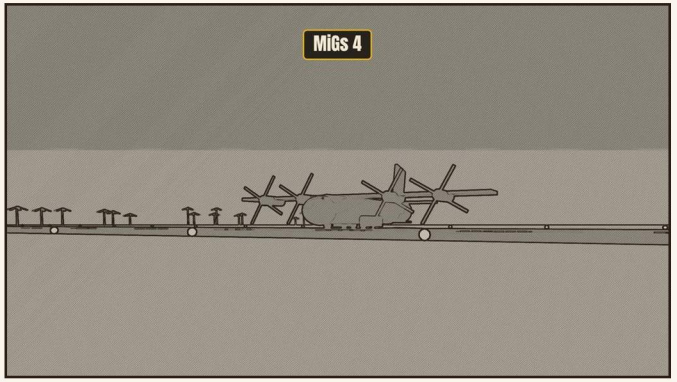
9.6 · 7.0s

VO The planes were on the ground for about ninety minutes. The assault itself took around thirty.
FRAME Two clocks: 90 MIN and 30 MIN
MOTION clock slam

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 9 HOME

9.7 · 4.6s

VO They fly to Nairobi, refuel, and head north for home.
FRAME Map: Entebbe to Nairobi to Israel
MOTION follow the route



9.8 · 7.8s

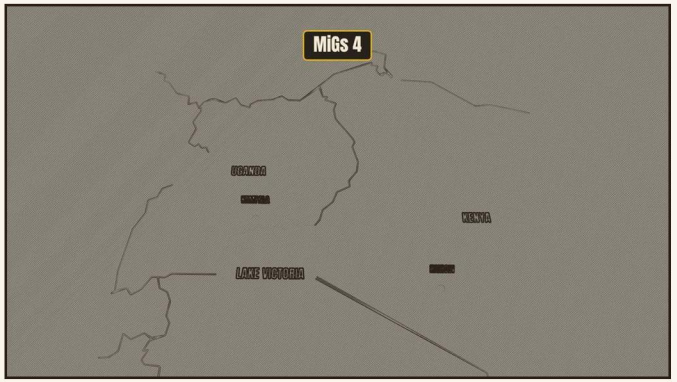
VO On 4 July, they land at Ben Gurion, the same airport the hostages left from eight days earlier.
FRAME Plane lands in morning sun, crowd waiting
MOTION low angle landing

9.9 · 5.0s

VO Families run onto the tarmac. People cry, sing and hug strangers.
FRAME Crowd hugging at the foot of the ramp
MOTION crane up over the crowd

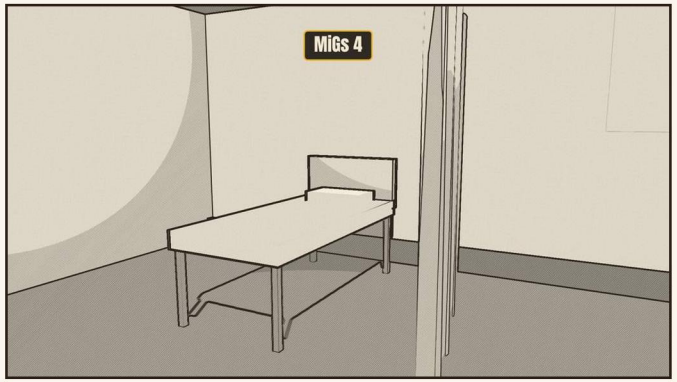
9.10 · 7.8s

VO In Uganda, Amin is furious. He blames his own army and turns on Kenya, which helped the Israelis.
FRAME Amin at a desk slamming a fist; map of Kenya behind
MOTION push in



9.11 · 4.6s

VO Hundreds of Kenyans living in Uganda were killed in revenge.
FRAME Dark map of Uganda and Kenya
MOTION slow sink



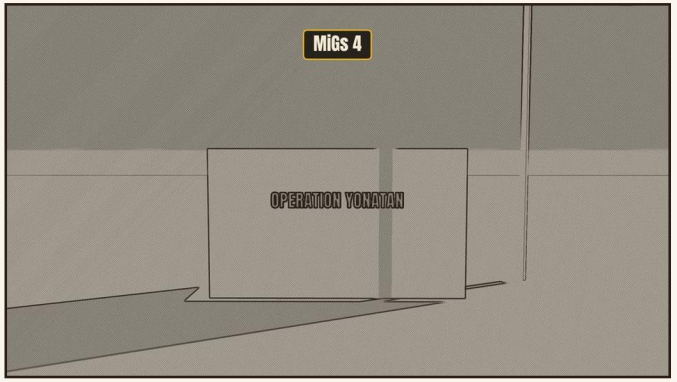
9.12 · 6.2s

VO And Dora Bloch, the seventy-five-year-old woman taken to hospital, was never seen alive again.
FRAME Empty hospital bed, curtain drawn
MOTION slow push on the curtain

OPERATION THUNDERBOLT STORYBOARD · ACT 9 HOME

9.13 · 8.6s

VO Years later, British records and a Ugandan inquiry said she was taken from her bed and killed on Amin's orders.
FRAME Document cards: "UK GOVERNMENT FILES", "UGANDA INQUIRY 1987"
MOTION card slides



9.14 · 7.4s

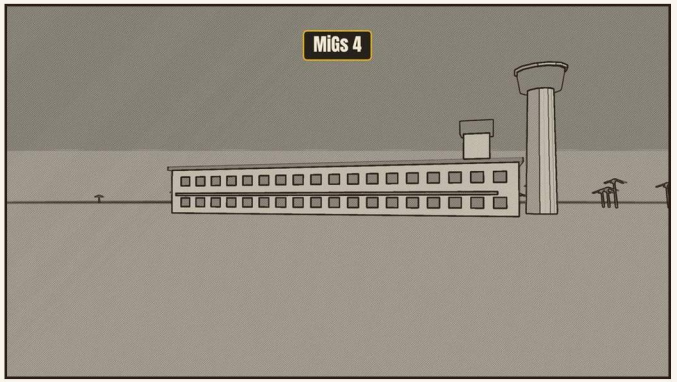
VO In Israel, Yoni Netanyahu became a national hero. The operation was renamed in his honour. Operation Yonatan.
FRAME Memorial with a flag, title card "OPERATION YONATAN"
MOTION slow push

9.15 · 7.0s

VO His younger brother Benjamin carried his name into politics. Twenty years later, he became prime minister.
FRAME Benjamin at a podium, generic house-style figure; date tag 1996
MOTION slow push

9.16 · 7.0s

VO Almost fifty years on, Entebbe is still called one of the boldest rescue missions ever attempted.
FRAME The four planes fly into sunrise
MOTION slow lateral dolly



9.17 · 7.0s

VO Four planes, four thousand kilometres, in the dark, in a country that wanted them to fail.
FRAME Final wide: the old terminal at dawn, empty
MOTION slow push

9.18 · 6.2s

VO If you want more stories like this, subscribe. See you in the next one.
FRAME End card with subscribe button
MOTION card slide